

Music & Drama

Year 2

Student Manual



Music & Acting

Year 2 Student Manual

Cambridge Early Years

The Hedgerow Band

First published 2026 by Prime Books, the publishing imprint of Prime School, Portugal.

Copyright © Prime School 2026. All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording or otherwise, without the prior written permission of the publisher, except that a school which has purchased this book may photocopy the writing frames for use with its own pupils.

An independent publication. This book is written, illustrated and published independently by Prime School. It is not endorsed by, affiliated with, sponsored by or otherwise connected to Cambridge Assessment International Education, Cambridge University Press & Assessment, or the University of Cambridge. Where this book refers to a curriculum framework it does so for the guidance of teachers only, and no approval of any kind is claimed or implied.

Trademarks. Cambridge and Cambridge Early Years are trademarks of the University of Cambridge. All other product and company names mentioned are the trademarks or registered trademarks of their respective owners. Their use in this book is for identification and educational reference only, and does not imply any endorsement.

Songs and rhymes. Every song printed in full in this book is a traditional work whose text is out of copyright, transcribed from the source recorded beside it rather than from any modern collection. Songs still in copyright, or whose authorship is disputed, are named for the teacher's reference and are not reproduced. The publisher has made every reasonable effort to establish the provenance of each text and welcomes any correction.

PRIME BOOKS · CONTINUED

- **Rain, Rain, Go Away**, English. First published 17th century or earlier. A true SO-MI song: the whole tune sits on two notes, which is why it opens the pitch work in this book. Recorded from the 17th century or earlier, so the text is long out of copyright. Set from the common oral version, which is the two lines above and nothing more; the longer variants are later additions and are not printed.
 - **Star Light, Star Bright**, American, sung throughout Britain. First published 1880s. Late nineteenth century and comfortably out of copyright. Another two-note so-mi chant in most classroom versions, which is why it appears in Unit 1 and returns in Unit 4 with the night songs.
 - **Bee, Bee, Bumble Bee**, English playground rhyme. First published traditional. A traditional playground counting-out chant with no known author, sung on so and mi. Set from the common oral version. It is printed because a so-mi unit needs more than one song a class can already almost sing.
 - **Snail, Snail**, English playground rhyme. First published traditional. A traditional two-note game song, author unknown, set from the common oral version. Its whole melody is so and mi, and its words are slow, which makes it the song Tessa the tortoise leads.
-

PRIME BOOKS · CONTINUED

- **Row, Row, Row Your Boat**, American, sung throughout Britain. First published 1852. First printed in 1852 and long out of copyright. It is in this unit because it is the round every Year 2 class can manage, and a round is the simplest true experience of layering.
 - **A Sailor Went to Sea**, English clapping song. First published traditional. A traditional clapping song with no known author, set from the common oral version. Printed here for its steady pulse and its repeated words, which is the pairing the water unit needs before the soundscapes.
 - **Hot Cross Buns**, English street cry. First published 1798 or earlier. An eighteenth-century London street cry, printed by the 1790s and long out of copyright. The most useful food song in the book: its words fall into ta and ti-ti exactly, so the rhythm work in topic 3.2 can be done on a song the class already knows.
 - **Pat-a-cake, Pat-a-cake**, English. First published 1698. One of the oldest recorded English nursery rhymes, appearing in a play of 1698. Set from the common oral version. Its syllables are so regular that it doubles as the clapping game for the pulse work.
 - **Polly Put the Kettle On**, English. First published 1803. Printed from 1803 and out of copyright. The repeated line is an ostinato in everything but name, which is why it sits beside topic 3.3.
 - **Pease Porridge Hot**, English. First published 1760. Recorded from about 1760 and out of copyright. A clapping game whose text is built out of food words, which is precisely what topic 3.2 asks for.
 - **Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star**, English words, French tune. First published 1806. The words are Jane Taylor's poem The Star, published in 1806, and the tune is the older French melody Ah! vous dirai-je, maman. Both are out of copyright. Mozart wrote variations on the tune and did not compose it, so his name is not attached to it here.
 - **I See the Moon**, English. First published traditional. A traditional rhyme with no known author, set from the common oral version. In the book it is offered as the quiet song for the dark half of the Turning Day, and a class may sing it or say it.
-

PRIME BOOKS · CONTINUED

- **When the Saints Go Marching In**, American gospel. First published 1896 (early published forms). A gospel hymn whose early published forms date from the 1890s, out of copyright. Printed here because its four lines repeat, so a whole class can learn it in one session and add percussion parts to it in the next.
 - **Auld Lang Syne**, Scots, Robert Burns. First published 1788. Robert Burns set this down in 1788 and it has been out of copyright for well over a century. The first verse and chorus only: that is what a class actually sings, and it is the song the book ends the year on.
 - **It's Raining, It's Pouring**, American. First published 1912 (first two lines), recorded 1939. NOT PRINTED. The obvious rain song for this unit, and the reason this file exists. Its first two lines are traceable only to The Little Mother Goose, published in the United States in 1912, and the rhyme as a whole is recorded from 1939. That is far too recent for a priced book to reproduce, however old the tune feels. Teachers may of course sing it with a class, and the book names it so they can.
 - **Kum Ba Yah**, African American spiritual, disputed. First published earliest known recording 1926. TUNE ONLY, WORDS NOT PRINTED. The authorship is genuinely disputed, with rival claims and an earliest known recording of 1926. Where authorship is contested, the safe reading is that somebody may hold a claim, so the melody may be sung and the text is not reproduced here.
 - **Happy Birthday to You**, American. First published melody 1893, familiar text later. NOT PRINTED. The most famous rights history in music: the familiar text was subject to a disputed claim for decades, settled in the United States in 2015 and 2016, and the position still differs between territories. A school singing it in a classroom and a publisher printing it in a priced book are not in the same position, and this book is the publisher.
 - **For He's a Jolly Good Fellow**, English. First published tune 18th century French, English text later. TUNE ONLY. The melody is the old French Malbrough s'en va-t-en guerre and is out of copyright, but the familiar English text has no single clear pre-1930 published source that could be verified, so it is not printed.
-

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Editorial and design: Prime Books studio, Lisbon.

Illustration: original watercolour artwork commissioned for this edition.

Series: Prime Books Student Manuals, Cambridge Early Years and Cambridge Primary.

Typeset in: Fraunces, Andika, Playpen Sans and Bravura.

Music setting: Bravura, the reference SMuFL font, used under the SIL Open Font Licence.

Facts and sources. Every "Otto's true thing" in this book was checked against a named authority before publication. Where a popular claim could not be traced to a reliable source it has been left out, or narrowed to the part that is documented, even where the fuller version is widely repeated. A full list of sources appears at the back of the book, together with a note of what was deliberately not said.

The codes in this book. Every square code leads to a real recording, score or article on a free and stable public archive, and every one carries a job to do beside it. They were each checked and found working before this book went to print. Nothing in this book depends on them: a class with no device to scan them with can do every single activity, and the name of each destination is printed underneath in case you would rather type it.

Safety. The activities in this book are designed for a classroom with a teacher present. Where an activity invites loud playing, a "Safe ears" note appears beside it. Please read those notes with the class.

ABOUT THIS BOOK • CONTINUED

Scheme of work. The five units and thirty topics of this book follow the Year 2 music scheme of work exactly, in the same order and under the same headings, so that any page can be matched to the scheme at a glance. The scheme's own wording for each topic is printed in the contents and again in the teacher's map at the back.

Printed on paper from responsibly managed sources.

Prime Books, Prime School, Portugal.

www.primeschool.pt

PRIME SCHOOL



Pip.

CONTENTS

What is in this book

Five units, and six topics in each one. The name in bold is what we call it in this book. The smaller line underneath is what your teacher calls it in the plan.

Unit 1	The Dawn Chorus Unit 1 Animal voices	
1.1	Wake the whole hedgerow up Vocal warm ups & exploring voice qualities (high/low, fast/slow, whisper, etc.)	.
1.2	Be the animal, sound and all Animal sound exploration with movement and imitation	.
1.3	So and mi, and two little lines Introduce so / mi (hand signs) and two-line stave	.
1.4	One animal, one steady beat Representing animals with classroom instruments to a steady pulse	.
1.5	Make up an animal piece Small-group improvisation/composition and short class performance	.
1.6	Looking back at the Dawn Chorus Reflection / assessment / portfolio evidence	.

CONTENTS · CONTINUED

Unit 2	The Stream Unit 2 Water, water, everywhere	
2.1	All the sounds water makes Explore water sounds and vocabulary (voice, body, objects)	.
2.2	So and mi songs, with actions Sing so/mi songs with actions (practise and consolidate)	.
2.3	Build a rainstorm out of layers Create soundscapes / texture building (parachute/props, layering)	.
2.4	Put the water in order Sequence and layer sounds (simple use of sequencing / organising sounds)	.
2.5	Three composers went to the water Listening examples (Raindrop, Vltava, Aquarium) and discussion	.
2.6	Show us the stream Performance / reflection / teacher feedback	.
Unit 3	The Long Table Unit 3 Musical food	
3.1	Ta, ti-ti, and the sound of nothing Introduce ta, ti-ti and sh (rest); pulse awareness activities	.
3.2	Every food word has a rhythm Match rhythms to food-word syllables and chant practise	.
3.3	A pattern that will not stop Compose simple rhythmic ostinatos and combine groups	.
3.4	Five notes, one long table Use pitched and unpitched instruments to perform parts (pentatonic CDEGA)	.
3.5	Play it, hear it, mend it Group performance, peer feedback and refinement	.
3.6	Looking back at the Long Table Short assessment / reflection / portfolio update	.

CONTENTS

Unit 4	The Turning Day Unit 4 Light and dark	
4.1	Bright music and shadowy music Listen and respond to light vs dark music; describe feelings	.
4.2	Writing rhythm down with sticks Continue ta / ti-ti / sh notation and stick notation practise	.
4.3	Move the way the music moves Movement responses and expressive choices to recorded music	.
4.4	Four beats, and what you put in them Compose small ta/ti-ti/sh patterns (groups) and organise into 4-beat structures	.
4.5	Loud, soft, and everything between Performances, class discussion on expression and dynamics	.
4.6	Looking back at the Turning Day Reflection / assessment	.
Unit 5	The Big Rock Unit 5 Celebration	
5.1	Choose the best of the year Select and revise favourite pieces from the year	.
5.2	Add a part, and then take one away Refine songs (add pulse, simple percussion parts, harmonies)	.
5.3	Write our own celebration song Compose and learn short celebratory songs as a class	.
5.4	Who does what, and when Rehearse performance logistics and run-throughs (groups)	.
5.5	The dress rehearsal Dress rehearsal / recording / final tweaks	.
5.6	The Big Rock concert Final performance, reflection and portfolio completion	.

And at the back

♪	The songbook: every song in this book, in one place	•
♪	Songs we did not print, and why	•
♪	All the words you learned, from A to Z	•
♪	Where every true thing came from	•
♪	Your certificate	•



The whole band, on the big rock.

WELCOME

A sound you make on purpose can be kept



Pip starts, and the whole hedgerow joins in.

Last year you found out something important: a sound is not just something that happens to you. You can **make** one, on purpose. Loud or soft. High or low. Fast or slow. Long or short. You choose.

This year you are going to do the next thing, and it is a bigger thing than it sounds.

You are going to keep the sounds you make.

You can keep a sound by remembering it. You can keep it by **writing it down**, which is why this book is full of little lines and sticks and dots. You can keep it by **putting it with somebody else's sound** until the two of them turn into a piece of music.

WELCOME • CONTINUED



The folder where a whole year is kept.

And then, at the very end, you give it away. That is what a performance is: you kept something all year, and now you hand it to people who are listening.

TUNE UP

Everything in this book happens in one hedgerow, on and around one big mossy rock. Seven animals live there and every one of them plays something, except two, and those two have the most important jobs of all.

Who is in this book

Nobody in this band wears any clothes, so you can tell them apart by **what they are carrying**. That is worth knowing: each one owns an idea, and when the animal turns up, so does the idea.



Pip, a robin. *ukulele and her own voice*

Pip owns the **tune**. When you see her, you are about to sing something, or find out where a note lives.



Bramble, a field mouse. *tambourine*

Bramble owns the **pulse**: the steady counting underneath everything. He never speeds up. Ever.



Nutkin, a red squirrel. *seed-pod shaker*

Nutkin owns **fast**, and he owns **ti-ti**: two sounds squeezed into one beat.

THE BAND • CONTINUED



Tessa, a tortoise. *a big low drum*

Tessa owns **slow, low** and **long**. She also owns the rest, which is the beat where nobody plays at all.



Hattie, a hedgehog. *a ridged scraper*

Hattie owns **layers**: what happens when your sound and somebody else's sound go on at the same time.



Otto, a little owl. *nothing at all*

Otto owns **listening**, and that is the hardest job in the band. Every true thing in this book is one he found out.



Badger, a badger. *nothing at all*

Badger owns the **signal**. He counts you in, he points at whoever plays next, and he decides when to stop.

The same four things, every time

- 1 Listen.** Before you play anything at all. Right to the end. You cannot copy something while it is still going on.
 - 2 Make.** Have a go. It will not be right the first time and that is not a problem, it is information.
 - 3 Keep.** Remember it, or write it down, or put it with somebody else's part. Now it exists even when nobody is playing.
 - 4 Give.** Play it to somebody. That is the whole point of keeping it.
-

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK • CONTINUED



Tune up

Badger is about to start you off



Out in the hedgerow

a story: what happened to the band this week



By the end you will

what this topic is for



warm up

wake your voice and your hands up first



Otto asks

do you remember? A question about last time



Learn

the new thing itself



Numbered jobs

your turn. Do these



Otto's true thing

something surprising, and it is really true



One step more

if you finished and want harder



Badger's challenge

the hard one. It is meant to be hard



Keep it

put this in your folder. It is your evidence



Safe ears

how to be loud without hurting anybody



Scan and listen

a square code, and a real recording behind it

Listening to the real thing

Some things cannot be printed. A robin singing cannot be printed. A river cannot be printed. A whole orchestra playing a piece about water cannot be printed either.

So this book has square codes in it. A grown-up points a phone or a tablet at one, and the real sound comes out. Every code in this book leads to a real recording or a real picture in a free public library, and every one of them has a **job** printed next to it. Do the job. That is what the code is for.



HEAR

🎵 Scan and hear

One real robin singing, recorded outdoors in Europe.
*Listen twice. The first time, just listen. The second time,
put your hand up every time the robin stops for a breath.*

European robin song, xeno-canto XC812816

THE SQUARE CODES • CONTINUED

That one is a real robin, recorded outdoors, by somebody who was standing there. It is the same bird that is on the front of this book.



The first job of all, and it needs no battery.

If you have no phone or tablet

Then you have lost nothing at all. Every single job in this book can be done without one. The name of each recording is printed underneath its code, so your teacher can look it up another time, or you can just get on with the music.

FOR TEACHERS

The codes resolve to Wikimedia Commons, Wikipedia, xeno-canto and IMSLP: free, stable, advertisement-free and requiring no account. Every destination was requested and confirmed live before this book went to print, and each printed image was decoded back to its own address at its printed size, so a code cannot point somewhere other than the caption claims.

No task in this book depends on a scan. Where a recording matters to the teaching, the activity is written so that your own voice, or a hand on a table, will do the same work.

What you need, and where to stand



A tambourine.



A shaker.

The instruments

You do not need many, and you do not need expensive ones. Everything in this book can be done with these:

something to shake

something to tap

something to scrape

a drum

five tuned bars or chime bars

your own two hands

your own voice

The last two are the important ones. They are also the two you cannot lose or forget to bring.

GETTING SET UP • CONTINUED



One raised paw: start, and stop.

Where to stand

In a **circle**, if you can. In a circle everybody can see everybody, which matters enormously the moment two groups have to play different things at the same time.

Keep one **clear space** in the middle. That is where whoever is performing stands, and it is where Badger stands when he is counting you in.

FOR TEACHERS

Two agreed hand signals are worth more than any amount of asking for quiet: one for START and one for STOP. Teach them in the first lesson and use nothing else all year. Pupils who know they will be stopped cleanly play far more freely.

A taped circle on the floor and a taped square in the middle of it will save you several minutes in every single lesson, and it makes the difference between two groups layering their parts and two groups shouting over each other.

Where a topic asks for five tuned notes, use C, D, E, G and A and remove the others if your instrument allows it. Taking F and B away is not a simplification: it is what makes it impossible for a pupil to play a wrong note, which is the whole reason the scheme names a pentatonic set.

Where you are going

Five places, one for each unit. You will end up back on the big rock where you started, but you will be able to do a great deal more when you get there.

🎵 UNIT 1: THE DAWN CHORUS

Every voice in the hedgerow is singing something, including yours.

🎵 UNIT 2: THE STREAM

Water never makes only one sound, so listen for the layers.

🎵 UNIT 3: THE LONG TABLE

Words are already made of rhythm, and you can eat the evidence.

YOUR YEAR • CONTINUED

🎵 UNIT 4: THE TURNING DAY

The same tune can be bright or shadowy, and you choose which.

🎵 UNIT 5: THE BIG ROCK

Everything you kept this year, given away in one afternoon.

🎵 START YOUR FOLDER NOW

- a folder, a big envelope or a wallet with your name on it
- everything you write down this year, even the messy first tries
- the sheets where you invented a pattern of your own
- a note of which songs you sang, so you can choose your favourites in Unit 5



Your folder. Keep everything.



The Dawn Chorus



Pip

owns the tune, and she starts the year off.

UNIT 1

The Dawn Chorus

Every voice in the hedgerow is singing something, including yours.

- 1 Wake your voice up, and choose which voice to use.
- 2 Sing so and mi, and show them with your hands.
- 3 Keep a steady pulse while somebody plays something else.

By the end of these six topics you will sing two notes, name them both, and read them off two lines.

THE SIX TOPICS IN THIS UNIT

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 1 Wake the whole hedgerow up | 2 Be the animal, sound and all |
| 3 So and mi, and two little lines | 4 One animal, one steady beat |
| 5 Make up an animal piece | 6 Looking back at the Dawn Chorus |

TOPIC 1.1

Wake the whole hedgerow up



Pip leads the warm up, and the whole hedgerow copies her: beaks open, mouths open, heads tipped back.

♪ OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

Pip was on the rock before anybody else was awake, and she was not singing yet. She was yawning.

Nutkin thought that was a waste of a good morning. But Pip knows something: a voice that has been asleep all night cannot sing straight away. It has to wake up first, and a big yawn is the fastest way to wake it.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ wake your voice up before you use it
- ★ make your voice go high, low, fast, slow and whispery on purpose
- ★ hear that a whisper is not just a quiet talk

warm
up

Yawn. A big one, with your arms up. Now do it again and let a sound come out of the yawn, sliding from as high as you can go down to as low as you can go.

TOPIC 1.1 · CONTINUED

 YOUR VOICE HAS MORE THAN ONE SETTING

You already know this without being told. You do not talk to a baby the way you shout across a playground, and you do not whisper a secret the way you sing a song.

your talking voice**your whispering voice****your calling voice****your singing voice**

Four settings, one mouth. You choose which one, every time you open it.

 A WHISPER DOES NOT BUZZ

Put two fingers gently on the front of your throat. Say your own name out loud. Feel that? That is buzzing.

Now whisper your name. The buzz stops completely. A whisper is not a small voice, it is a **different** voice, made without the buzzing part at all.

TOPIC 1.1 · CONTINUED

🎵 HIGH IS NOT THE SAME AS LOUD

This catches nearly everybody out. High and low are about how **fast** something is wobbling, not how **big** the wobble is. You can sing a high note very quietly and a low note very loudly.



high, like a wren at the top of a
stem



Nutkin wakes his voice up.



middle, like
talking



Hattie whispers. No buzz at all.



low, like Tessa's
drum



HEAR

🎵 Scan and hear

One real robin singing, recorded outdoors in Europe.
Listen twice. The first time, just listen. The second time,
put your hand up every time the robin stops for a breath.

European robin song, xeno-canto XC812816

TOPIC 1.1 · CONTINUED

YOUR TURN

- 1 Yawn and stretch three times. On the third one, let a sound slide out of your mouth, from as high as you can go all the way down to as low as you can go.

whheeeee, all the way down

SING IT

- 2 Put two fingers on the front of your throat. Say your name, then whisper it. Which one made your fingers buzz?

- 3 Be a wren: say good morning in your highest voice. Now be Tessa: say it in your lowest. Now be you.

- 4 Sing one note twice, first as loudly as you can and then as softly as you can. Did the note stay in the same place, high or low?

- 5 Say the same four words four times over: in your talking voice, your whispering voice, your calling voice and your singing voice. Your partner shuts their eyes and names each one.

- 6 Slide your voice slowly from your lowest note to your highest with no bumps in it, like a slide and not like stairs.

TOPIC 1.1 · CONTINUED

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

You sing with your throat, but a bird does not. A bird has a special sound box called a syrinx, deep in its chest where its windpipe splits in two. That is why some birds can sing two notes at the same time.

► ONE STEP MORE

Try the slide again with your hand moving up with it. Then try to stop your voice exactly where your hand stops. It is much harder than it sounds.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Sing one note and hold it while a friend walks all the way across the room. Take a big breath first, and do not run out halfway.

♪ Words from Topic 1.1

**voice**

the sound you make

**high**

a fast wobble

**low**

a slow wobble

**whisper**

talking with no buzz



Nutkin crouches low to be a mouse while Bramble stretches tall to be an owl. Otto is not fooled for a moment.

TOPIC 1.2

Be the animal, sound and all

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

Otto asked everybody to be an animal, without saying which one, and see if the others could guess.

Nutkin did a very good mouse. Bramble did a terrible owl. And then Tessa did something nobody expected: she did not make a sound at all, she just moved, very slowly, and everybody knew at once.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ copy an animal sound with your voice
- ★ copy an animal with your body as well as your voice
- ★ notice that moving and sounding go together

warm
up

Be a cat waking up. Stretch, and let a long slow sound come out while you stretch. Now be a bird waking up: short, quick and high.

TOPIC 1.2 · CONTINUED

Which of your four voices did you use to be the cat? And did you have to change your body to do it, or only your mouth?

♪ COPYING IS HOW YOU LEARN A SOUND

You cannot get better at a sound by being told about it. You get better by **hearing it and having a go**, then hearing it again and having another go.

The trick is to listen right to the **end** before you start. Most copies go wrong because the copying started too early.

♪ YOUR BODY IS PART OF YOUR VOICE

Try being a big slow bear while standing on your toes with your shoulders up by your ears. It is almost impossible.

Animals sound the way they sound partly because of how they are **shaped** and how they **move**. So when you copy an animal, move like it too. The sound arrives much more easily.

TOPIC 1.2 · CONTINUED

♪ LOUD, SOFT, FAST, SLOW

Every animal in the hedgerow picks a different corner of those four words. A mouse is quick and quiet. Tessa is slow and low. A cockerel is slow and extremely loud.

FOUR ANIMALS, FOUR CORNERS

a mouse quick, quiet, high

a robin quick, bright, high

a badger slow, low, gruff

a cockerel slow and as loud as it can manage

**HEAR****♪ Scan and hear**

A blackbird singing its long, low, unhurried song.

Listen to the blackbird, then listen to the robin again.

Which one sings higher? Which one sings faster? Say why you think so.

Common blackbird song on Wikimedia Commons

TOPIC 1.2 · CONTINUED



Safe ears. When the whole class is being a cockerel at once, that is loud. Do it for four counts and then stop. If your ears feel funny, tell your teacher straight away.

- 1 Choose an animal and be it, sound and movement together, for a count of five. The rest of the class guesses.

VOICE OFF

- 2 Do your animal twice: once as loudly as it really is, and once as quietly as you can while keeping it the same animal.

- 3 Two of you at once: one fast animal and one slow animal, side by side, for a count of eight. Do not let each other change speed.

- 4 Line the class up from lowest voice to highest voice. You will have to keep making your sound while you move, to find your place.

TOPIC 1.2 · CONTINUED

- 5** Otto's game: everybody makes their animal sound at the same time. Otto shuts his eyes and points at the one he can pick out. Then swap over.

VOICE OFF

- 6** Be an animal with NO sound at all, only movement, like Tessa did. Can the class still guess it?

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

A cricket does not have a voice at all. It rubs one wing against the other, like drawing a stick along a comb, and that is the chirping you hear on a summer evening.

► ONE STEP MORE

Be two animals at once: a slow body and a fast voice. It feels wrong, which is exactly why it is worth trying.

TOPIC 1.2 • CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Be an animal getting further and further away. Everything has to get quieter without getting slower, and that is genuinely hard.

♪ Words from Topic 1.2

**copy**

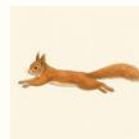
do it exactly the same

**loud**

a big sound

**soft**

a small sound

**fast**

hurrying

**slow**

taking your time

TOPIC 1.3

So and mi, and two little lines

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

The cuckoo arrived, sang two notes, and left again.

Otto said that was the whole song. Nutkin did not believe him and waited all afternoon for a third note. It never came. A cuckoo only ever sings two, and it is always the same two.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ sing the two notes called so and mi
- ★ show so and mi with your hands
- ★ read so and mi from two lines on the page



Pip perches on the upper of two long bramble stems. Otto holds one wing out flat and level to show the sign.

warm
up

Sing the cuckoo. Two notes, the higher one first, then the lower one. Now do it again with your hand high for the first note and low for the second.

TOPIC 1.3 • CONTINUED

Yesterday you found out that high is not the same as loud. So can you sing the cuckoo's two notes very softly, and keep them in the same two places?

 TWO NOTES HAVE NAMES: SO AND MI

Out of all the notes in the world, this year starts with just two. The higher one is called **so**. The lower one is called **mi**.

Two notes does not sound like much. But you can already sing several real songs with only these two, and you are going to.

 YOUR HANDS CAN SHOW THEM

Musicians have used hand signs for these notes for over a hundred and fifty years. Your hand is flat and level for both of them. The only difference is **how high you hold it**.

TOPIC 1.3 • CONTINUED

♪ AND TWO LINES CAN SHOW THEM TOO

Here is the clever bit. If you only have two notes, you only need **two lines** to write them down.

so sits on the top line. **mi** sits on the bottom line. That is the entire rule, and now you can read music.



so

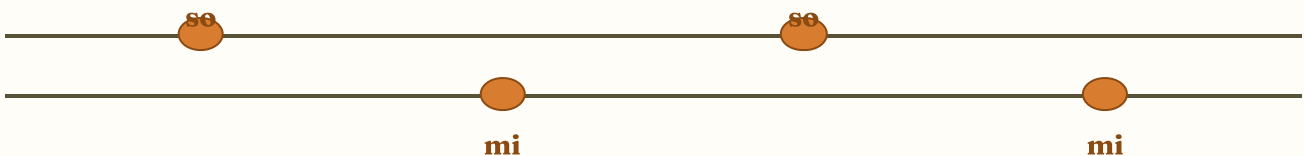
a flat hand, palm down, held higher



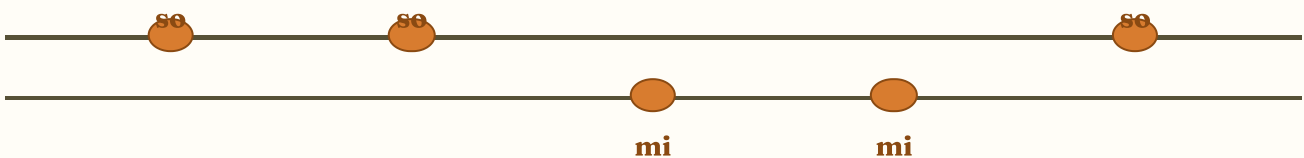
mi

a flat hand, palm down, level

POINT AT EACH ONE AND SING IT: SO, MI, SO, MI



NOW THIS ONE. TWO THE SAME, TWO THE SAME, THEN BACK UP



TOPIC 1.3 • CONTINUED



Two stems, two places to be. Nowhere else to go.



HEAR

🎵 **Scan and hear**

A cuckoo calling: two notes, over and over, always the same two.

Sing the cuckoo's two notes back. The higher one is so and the lower one is mi, and those two are the only notes in this whole unit.

Common cuckoo, xeno-canto XC457076 on Wikimedia Commons

YOUR TURN

- 1 Sing so and mi from Otto's hand signs. Your teacher signs, you sing. No talking.

so ... mi ... so ... mi

SING IT

- 2 Swap over. You do the signs and the class sings. Try to catch them out.

- 3 Read the first two-line pattern above, pointing at each note as you sing it.

- 4 Read the second pattern. It has two of the same note in a row twice, so do not let your voice slide about in between.

TOPIC 1.3 • CONTINUED

- 5** Sing Rain, Rain, Go Away. The whole tune is so and mi and nothing else. Put your hand up on every so.

SING IT

- 6** Make up your own four-note pattern using only so and mi, sign it to your partner, and see if they can sing it back.

 OTTO'S TRUE THING

The cuckoo sings only two notes, over and over, and always the same two. The higher one and the lower one are exactly the two notes you are learning to sing in this unit.

 ONE STEP MORE

Sing a pattern of six so-mi notes while your partner writes it down on two lines. Then check it by singing what they wrote.

TOPIC 1.3 • CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Half the class sings so, all together, and holds it. The other half sings mi, all together, and holds it. Listen to what the two of you have made.

♪ KEEP IT

- your own two-line pattern, drawn on two lines
- a note of which songs you found that used only so and mi

♪ Words from Topic 1.3

**so**

the higher of the two notes

**mi**

the lower of the two notes

**hand sign**

showing a note with your hand

**stave**

the lines music is written on

TOPIC 1.4

One animal, one steady beat

**warm
up**

Walk on the spot, slowly and evenly, while Bramble's beat plays. Now stop walking but keep the beat going with one hand on your knee.



Bramble keeps a steady beat while Tessa walks in time with it and Hattie taps the rock to match.

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

Bramble started tapping. Nothing else, just tapping, exactly the same speed, for a very long time.

One by one everybody else joined in, and something odd happened: they all stopped hurrying. Even Nutkin. A steady beat does that to a group of animals.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ keep a steady pulse without speeding up
- ★ choose an instrument that sounds like your animal
- ★ play your animal on the beat, not just whenever you like

TOPIC 1.4 · CONTINUED

Otto asks: what happened to everybody when Bramble started tapping? Did they get faster or slower, or neither?

♪ THE PULSE IS THE STEADY ONE UNDERNEATH

The **pulse** is the plain, even counting that goes on underneath music. It does not get excited. It does not slow down at the sad bit. It is the thing everybody else fits around.

You have one inside you already. Your heart has been keeping a pulse since before you were born, and it never once asked you to help.

♪ CHOOSING THE RIGHT INSTRUMENT

An instrument is not just a noise, it is a **choice**. A shaker cannot be a badger. A big low drum cannot be a wren.

So before you play, ask two questions. Is my animal **high or low**? Is my animal **fast or slow**? Then pick something that agrees with both answers.

TOPIC 1.4 · CONTINUED

🎵 PLAYING ON THE BEAT

Playing your animal is easy. Playing your animal **exactly when the beat comes** is the actual skill, and it takes practice.

FOUR STEADY BEATS. COUNT THEM OUT LOUD

1

2

3

4

PLAY ON 1 AND 3, AND FEEL 2 AND 4 WITHOUT PLAYING

1

2

3

4



The same paw, four times, exactly the same distance apart.



HEAR

🎵 Scan and hear

A tawny owl hooting at night, with long silences in between. Count slowly and steadily while you listen. How many counts long is the owl's silence? Silence is part of the music too.

Tawny owl on Wikimedia Commons

TOPIC 1.4 • CONTINUED

YOUR TURN



Safe ears. A drum is exciting and it is easy to hit it far harder than the music needs. Play it so you can still hear the person next to you. If you cannot hear them, you are too loud.

- 1 Count to four out loud, over and over, all together, as evenly as you can. Somebody claps on every 1.

one two three four

VOICE OFF

- 2 Choose an instrument for your animal and say out loud why you chose it. High or low? Fast or slow?

- 3 Play your animal once on every beat, for eight beats. Then once on every other beat.

- 4 Half the class keeps the pulse and the other half plays their animals on top of it. Then swap. The pulse half must not speed up.

TOPIC 1.4 • CONTINUED

- 5 Tessa's turn: keep a pulse so slow that you can walk two steps between each beat. It is far harder than a fast one.

VOICE OFF

- 6 Everybody stops on beat 8 without anybody counting out loud. You will have to be counting inside your head.

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

You have been keeping a steady beat since before you were born. Your heart does it all day and all night without being asked, and it does not speed up just because the music does.

➤ ONE STEP MORE

Keep the pulse in your head only, with no sound at all, for eight beats. Then come back in on beat 9. Did the class come back in together?

TOPIC 1.4 · CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Bramble's test. Keep a pulse going while your teacher talks over the top of it, at a completely different speed, trying to put you off.

🎵 Words from Topic 1.4

**pulse**

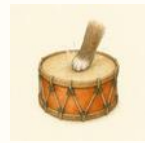
the steady beat
underneath

**steady**

always the same speed

**instrument**

a thing made for making
sound

**beat**

one tap of the pulse



Three groups in three huddles on the grass, each making up its own animal piece at the same time.

TOPIC 1.5

Make up an animal piece

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

Badger said the band had four minutes to invent something, and then he would be listening.

Four minutes is not very long. But it turned out to be plenty, because nobody had time to argue about it.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ make up a short piece with your group
- ★ give your piece a beginning, a middle and an end
- ★ perform it for the class and listen to theirs

**warm
up**

In your group, take it in turns to make one sound each, going round the circle. Do not plan it. Just go round twice.

TOPIC 1.5 • CONTINUED



READ

🎵 Scan and read

Why so many birds sing at once, very early, and then stop.

Ask your teacher to read this to you, then decide as a class what time you would have to wake up to hear it.

Dawn chorus, Wikipedia

🎵 MAKING IT UP IS ALLOWED

Inventing music on the spot has a proper name: **improvising**. It is what the whole band does when Badger gives them four minutes.

The only rule is that you must actually start. A group that talks about it for four minutes has nothing to play.

🎵 EVERY PIECE NEEDS THREE THINGS

A **beginning**, so the audience knows it has started. A **middle**, where the interesting bit happens. And an **end**, so the audience knows to clap.

The end is the one groups forget. A piece that just stops because everybody ran out is not finished, it is abandoned.

TOPIC 1.5 • CONTINUED

 LAYERS: EVERYBODY AT ONCE, ON PURPOSE

If all three of you play at the same time, that is not a mess. That is **layers**, and it is how most music in the world works.

It only works if you all share the same pulse. Look at the three parts below: slow, steady and quick, and every one of them lines up.

Three animals, one pulse: slow, steady and quick together**Tessa**

big low drum

ta a ta a

4

TIMES

Bramble

tambourine

ta ta ta ta

4

TIMES

Nutkin

seed-pod shaker

ti ti ti ti ti ti ti ti

4

TIMES

TOPIC 1.5 • CONTINUED

- 1 In your group, choose one animal each. Say out loud which one you are.

VOICE OFF

- 2 Decide who starts. Then decide how the piece ends: all together, or one at a time until nobody is left?

- 3 Play it once, all the way through, without stopping to fix anything.

- 4 Now fix one thing. Only one. Then play it again.

- 5 Perform it to the class. Stand still and wait for quiet before you start.

- 6 Listen to another group. Say one thing you liked, using a word from this unit.

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

Very early in the morning, birds all start singing at once. It is called the dawn chorus, and different kinds of bird join in at different times, so the chorus changes while it goes on.

TOPIC 1.5 • CONTINUED

► ONE STEP MORE

Add a silence to the middle of your piece, where absolutely nobody plays for two beats. Silence is much more surprising than noise.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Perform your piece with your group standing in three different corners of the room, so you cannot see each other. You will have to listen instead of watching.

♪ KEEP IT

- a drawing or a plan of your group's piece
- the names of who played what
- one sentence about what you would change next time

♪ Words from Topic 1.5

**improvise**

make it up as you go

**layer**

sounds happening at the same time

**together**

at the same moment

**perform**

play it for other people

TOPIC 1.6

Looking back at the Dawn Chorus

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

Otto did not play anything all unit. He listened to every single thing.

At the end he said the thing he had noticed most was not a sound at all. It was that the groups who **waited** before they started were the ones who stayed together.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ look back at what you learned in this unit
- ★ put your evidence into your folder
- ★ say what you want to get better at



Sing the cuckoo one more time. Two notes. Then show them with your hands, with no sound at all.

TOPIC 1.6 • CONTINUED

Otto asks: which of the four voices do you use most in a normal day? And which one do you use least?

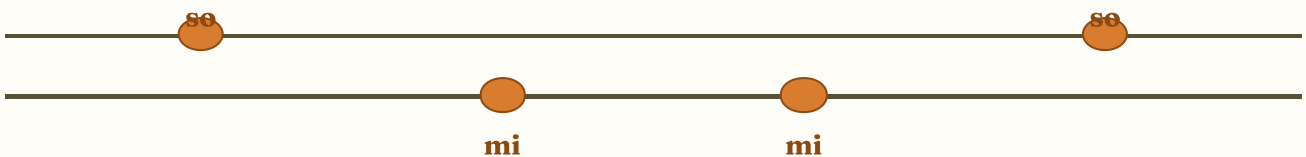
♪ **WHAT YOU CAN DO NOW THAT YOU COULD NOT DO BEFORE**

Six weeks ago you had a voice and you used it. Now you can pick which voice, on purpose. You can sing two notes and name them both. You can read them off two lines. And you can keep a pulse while somebody else is playing something completely different.

♪ **YOUR FOLDER IS THE PROOF**

Anybody can say they can do something. Your folder **shows** it. That is why the messy first tries go in it as well as the neat ones: they are the evidence that you got better.

CAN YOU STILL READ THIS? SING IT



TOPIC 1.6 • CONTINUED



Everything goes in. Even the messy ones.



LISTEN

🎵 Scan and listen

A composer painting a whole aviary of birds with a flute and a piano.

Listen for the flute. It is being a bird. Show with your hand how high the bird is flying while the flute plays.

Saint-Saens, The Carnival of the Animals: Voliere, on Wikimedia Commons

YOUR TURN

- 1 Sing a so-mi pattern your teacher signs, with no notes on the page to help you.
- 2 Write your own so-mi pattern on two lines. Four notes. Then sing it.
- 3 Keep a steady pulse for sixteen beats while your partner plays their animal on top.

SING IT

TOPIC 1.6 · CONTINUED

- 4 Say which animal you were in your group's piece, and why you chose that instrument for it.

VOICE OFF

- 5 Sort your folder out. Every sheet, in the order you made them.

- 6 Tell your teacher one thing from this unit you want another go at.

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

A singing bird is usually doing one of two jobs: telling other birds that this hedge is taken, or looking for a mate. It is a message, not just a nice noise.

► ONE STEP MORE

Teach your so-mi pattern to somebody who is not in your class, using only hand signs. If they can sing it back, you have taught somebody to read music.

TOPIC 1.6 · CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Otto's challenge, and it is the hardest one in the unit. Sit completely still and silent for one whole minute and afterwards name five sounds you heard.

♪ KEEP IT

- every so-mi pattern you wrote, tidy ones and messy ones
- your group's plan from Topic 1.5
- one sentence: the thing I am proudest of in this unit
- one sentence: the thing I want another go at

♪ Words from Topic 1.6

**listen**

the first job of all

**portfolio**

the folder where you
keep your work

**dawn**

the very start of the
day

**chorus**

everybody singing at
once



Otto sits beside a stack of leaf-paper and a woven grass folder, with the instruments laid down in a neat row.

END OF UNIT 1

The Dawn Chorus: what can you do now?

Tick the ones you can do. If a box is empty, that is not a problem: it just tells you what to have another go at.

- ☐ wake my voice up before I sing
- ☐ choose my talking, whispering, calling or singing voice on purpose
- ☐ make my voice go high and low without getting louder
- ☐ copy an animal sound with my voice and my body
- ☐ sing so and mi, and show them with my hands
- ☐ read so and mi from two lines
- ☐ keep a steady pulse without speeding up
- ☐ play my part while somebody else plays a different one
- ☐ make up a short piece with a beginning, a middle and an end
- ☐ listen right to the end before I join in



Otto listened to all of it.

END OF UNIT 1 • CONTINUED



The whole band, at the end of the Dawn Chorus.

How did it go?

Colour one circle for each line. Green for yes, yellow for nearly, orange for not yet.

Singing so and mi	
Reading so and mi on two lines	
Keeping a steady pulse	
Playing on the beat with other people	
Making up a piece in a group	
Listening while somebody else performs	

UNIT 2

The Stream

Water never makes only one sound, so listen for the layers.

- 1 Hear the separate sounds inside one sound of water.
- 2 Build a soundscape out of layers that grows and passes.
- 3 Put your sounds in an order and play it the same way twice.



The Stream



Hattie

owns layers: your sound and somebody else's, at once.

You will build a rainstorm that grows, passes, and leaves the same sound it started with.

THE SIX TOPICS IN THIS UNIT

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| 1 All the sounds water makes | 2 So and mi songs, with actions |
| 3 Build a rainstorm out of layers | 4 Put the water in order |
| 5 Three composers went to the water | 6 Show us the stream |

TOPIC 2.1

All the sounds water makes



Rain drips off a broad leaf into a puddle. Bramble catches one drip in a cupped paw and Hattie splashes another.

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

It rained all night, and in the morning Otto said something odd. He said he had been listening to seven different sounds.

Everybody else had heard one sound: rain. But Otto had heard rain on a leaf, rain on a stone, rain into a puddle, rain running down a stem, and three more he could not name. It was all the same water.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ hear that water makes many different sounds, not one
- ★ copy a water sound with your voice and with your hands
- ★ put a name to the sound you are making

TOPIC 2.1 • CONTINUED

warm
up

Make the smallest sound you possibly can with your hands. Now make one drop of water landing. Now make a whole puddle being jumped in.

 WATER CHANGES ITS SOUND DEPENDING ON WHAT IT HITS

Water does not have a sound of its own. It borrows one from whatever it lands on.

Rain on a window is sharp and tapping. Rain on grass is almost nothing. Rain into a puddle is round and hollow. Same rain, three sounds.

 WORDS FOR WATER SOUNDS

English has a lot of words for what water does, and they nearly all sound like the thing they mean. Say them out loud and you will hear it.

drip

trickle

splash

pour

ripple

gurgle

drum

rush

A word that sounds like its own meaning is doing two jobs at once. Those are useful words for a musician.

TOPIC 2.1 • CONTINUED

🎵 THREE WAYS TO MAKE A WATER SOUND

You can use your **voice**. You can use your **body**: fingertips, palms, a hand brushed across a sleeve. Or you can use an **object**: a shaker, a bottle, a scraper.

All three count. The voice is the one you will always have with you.

FOUR WATER SOUNDS, SMALLEST TO BIGGEST

 **drip** one small sound, then nothing

 **trickle** small sounds, one after another, not stopping

 **splash** one big sound, all at once

 **rush** loud, and it does not stop at all



One drop, about to fall.



Rings on a puddle.

TOPIC 2.1 • CONTINUED



HEAR

🎵 Scan and hear

Real rain, with no music and nobody talking.

Listen with your eyes shut. Then name three different sounds inside the one sound of rain.

The sound of rain, Wikimedia Commons

YOUR TURN

- 1 Listen to the rain recording with your eyes shut. Then name three different sounds you heard inside the one sound of rain. VOICE OFF
- 2 Make a drip with your voice. Then make the same drip with one finger on the table. Which was more like the real thing?
- 3 Make a trickle that does not stop for a count of eight. You will have to breathe cleverly, or use your hands instead.
- 4 In pairs: one of you makes a water sound, the other names it from the word bank without looking.
- 5 Find three objects in the room that can make a water sound. Play all three and choose the best one.

TOPIC 2.1 • CONTINUED

- 6 The whole class makes rain: fingertips only, very quietly, for a count of sixteen. Nobody may get louder.

VOICE OFF

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

Rain does not make one sound. Rain on a leaf, rain on a window, rain on a puddle and rain on a roof are four different sounds, all made by the same water.

► ONE STEP MORE

Make the sound of rain STARTING. It is much harder than rain already happening, because you have to begin with almost nothing.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Make a water sound your teacher cannot name. It has to be a real water sound, and you have to be able to say what it is afterwards.

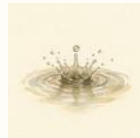
♪ Words from Topic 2.1

**drip**

one drop landing

**trickle**

a small run of water

**splash**

water hit hard

**pour**

water tipped out



Pip and Bramble sing a two-note song together, one wing and one paw held flat at different heights.

TOPIC 2.2

So and mi songs, with actions

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

Pip decided the rain needed a song, so she taught everybody one. It has two notes in it. Only two.

Nutkin complained that two notes was not enough for a proper song. Then he sang it four times without stopping and forgot to complain again.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ sing a whole song using only so and mi
- ★ add an action that shows which note you are on
- ★ keep the two notes in the same two places every time

**warm
up**

Sign so and mi with your hand while your teacher sings them. Now swap: you sing, your teacher signs.

TOPIC 2.2 · CONTINUED

Otto asks: which note is higher, so or mi? And where does so sit when you write it on two lines?

 A SONG YOU ALREADY HALF KNOW

This one has been sung by children for hundreds of years, and its whole tune is so and mi.

Rain, Rain, Go Away

Rain, rain, go away,
Come again another day.

Two lines of words, two notes of music. That is a complete song, and you can already read it.

 ACTIONS HOLD THE NOTES FOR YOU

Do the same action every time you sing **so**, and a different one every time you sing **mi**. Your body starts to remember the tune for you.

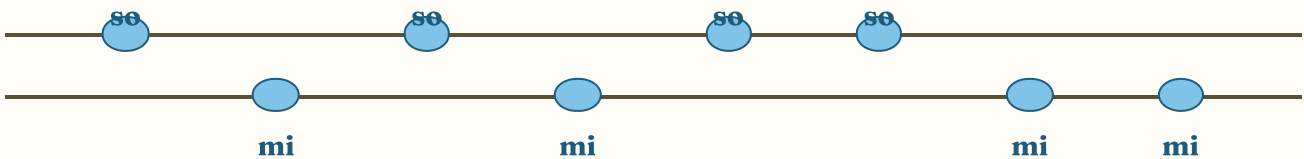
This is not a trick for small children. Singers do it all their lives.

TOPIC 2.2 · CONTINUED

🎵 PRACTISE MEANS THE SAME THING AGAIN, BETTER

You have sung so and mi before. Doing it again is not going backwards: it is how the two notes become something you know rather than something you are working out.

RAIN, RAIN, GO AWAY: POINT AND SING



so

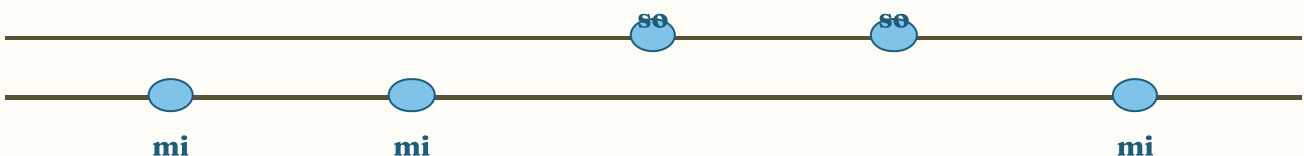
a flat hand, palm down, held higher



mi

a flat hand, palm down, level

A DIFFERENT ONE. WATCH OUT FOR THE TWO MI AT THE START



TOPIC 2.2 · CONTINUED



HEAR

🎵 Scan and hear

The same water, made to do three different things.

Copy each of the three water sounds with your voice. Then copy them with your hands only.

Water flowing, pouring and trickling, Wikimedia Commons

YOUR TURN

- 1 Sing Rain, Rain, Go Away all the way through. Put your hand high on every so and low on every mi.
rain, rain, go a-way

SING IT

- 2 Sing it again with your eyes shut and no hands. Did the tune stay in the same two places?

- 3 Invent one action for so and one for mi. Teach them to your partner and sing the song with them.

- 4 Read the second pattern above and sing it. It starts on mi, which catches people out.

TOPIC 2.2 · CONTINUED

- 5 Sing the song as softly as you possibly can, then as loudly as is sensible. The two notes must not move.

SING IT

- 6 Half the class sings the song while the other half copies the water trickle from Topic 2.1 underneath it.

 OTTO'S TRUE THING

If you fill bottles with different amounts of water and tap them, each one sings a different note. The more water there is, the lower the note goes.

 ONE STEP MORE

Sing the song starting on a different note, higher or lower. The tune should still sound like itself, because the GAP between so and mi has not changed.

TOPIC 2.2 · CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Sing the song as a two-part round: one half starts, the other half waits until the second line. Neither half may speed up to catch the other.

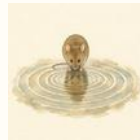
♪ Words from Topic 2.2

**so**

the higher note

**mi**

the lower note

**ripple**rings spreading on
water**wave**

water rolling over

TOPIC 2.3

Build a rainstorm out of layers

♪ OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

Badger said they were going to make a storm. Nutkin immediately made the loudest noise he could manage.

Badger stopped him. A storm does not start loud, he said. A storm starts with one drop, and then another, and then you cannot count them any more. That is the interesting part, and Nutkin had skipped it.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ build a soundscape out of separate layers
- ★ come in one at a time to make it grow
- ★ keep your own layer going while others come in



The whole band makes a rainstorm: shaker, scraper, tambourine and low drum, with water running everywhere.

TOPIC 2.3 · CONTINUED

A blue circular icon with the words "warm up" in white text.

One person starts a very quiet sound and keeps it going. Everybody else joins in, one at a time, without anybody saying when.

 A blue musical note icon. **A SOUNDSCAPE IS A PLACE MADE OF SOUND**

A **soundscape** is not a tune. It is a place. Shut your eyes in a good one and you know where you are.

A place is never made of one sound. That is why a soundscape needs **layers**: several sounds going at once, each doing its own job.

 A blue musical note icon. **LAYERS ONLY WORK IF YOU ALL SHARE THE PULSE**

Four different sounds at once is music. Four different sounds at four different speeds is a mess.

So everybody counts to four together, over and over, and each group fits its own part into that four. Look at the four parts below: they are all different, and every one of them lines up.

TOPIC 2.3 · CONTINUED

 GROWING AND SHRINKING

A storm that is loud all the way through is boring after ten seconds. Come in **one layer at a time** to grow it, then take layers away **one at a time** to let it pass.

The last sound left should be the first sound you started with. Then the storm has gone somewhere else, and that is a proper ending.

Four layers, one storm. Everybody counts to four together
Tessa

big low drum

ta a a a

8

TIMES

Bramble

tambourine

drop drop drop drop

8

TIMES

Nutkin

seed-pod shaker

rain rain rain rain rain rain rain rain

8

TIMES

Hattie

ridged scraper

ta a ta a

8

TIMES

TOPIC 2.3 · CONTINUED



Three bands of rain, near, middle and far.



A big leaf, held at the edges and lifted.



HEAR

🎵 Scan and hear

Many frogs at once: a real example of layers, not one sound but dozens.

This is a layered piece made by frogs. Point at the loudest layer, then the quietest one you can still hear.

Frogs croaking in a chorus at night, Wikimedia Commons

YOUR TURN

👉 **Safe ears.** A four-layer storm with instruments gets genuinely loud. Play it so you can still hear the group next to you, and stop as soon as your teacher raises a hand. If your ears feel odd afterwards, say so straight away.

- 1 Split into four groups and take one layer each. Say your words out loud in time, with no instruments at all, until every group is steady.

VOICE OFF

TOPIC 2.3 · CONTINUED

- 2 Now add instruments. Same words in your head, same four beats.
- 3 Come in one group at a time, four beats apart, until all four are playing.
- 4 Go out one group at a time, four beats apart, until only the first group is left. Then stop together.
- 5 Listen to the frog chorus recording. Point at the loudest layer, then at the quietest one you can still hear.
VOICE OFF
- 6 Do the whole storm again with your eyes shut. You will have to listen instead of watching.

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

Frogs call together in a chorus, and they take turns. If they all called at exactly the same moment, no frog could be heard on its own.

► ONE STEP MORE

Add a fifth layer that only happens ONCE, in the middle: one enormous thunderclap. Everything else keeps going.

TOPIC 2.3 · CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Perform the storm with no conductor at all. You must come in and go out by listening, not by watching Badger.

🎵 Words from Topic 2.3

**soundscape**

a place made of sound

**layer**

one part of several at once

**texture**

how thick or thin the sound is

**thick**

many layers at once

**thin**

only one or two

TOPIC 2.4

Put the water in order

**warm
up**

Three sounds: a drip, a splash and a rush. Do them in that order. Now do them backwards. Which order sounds more like a real storm?



Five puddles in a row, each larger than the last, with Badger stepping from the smallest to the biggest.

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

The storm had been good. But when they tried it again, it came out completely differently, and nobody could remember what they had done.

So Hattie put five stones in a row on the rock, one for each thing that happened, in order. After that they could play it the same way twice, which meant they could make it better.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ put sounds into an order and keep to it
- ★ read your order back and perform it the same way twice
- ★ decide what goes first, what goes last, and why

TOPIC 2.4 • CONTINUED

Otto asks: in Topic 2.3, what was the last sound left at the end of the storm? And why that one?

♪ A SEQUENCE IS AN ORDER YOU CAN KEEP

A **sequence** is a list of sounds in the order they happen. Once it is written down, you can play the same piece twice, and that is what lets you improve it.

You do not need to know how to write music. Five stones in a row will do. So will five drawings, or five words.

♪ FIRST AND LAST ARE THE IMPORTANT ONES

The **first** sound tells the audience what kind of piece this is. The **last** sound tells them it has finished, so they know when to clap.

Everything in between is the middle, and the middle is where you are allowed to be surprising.



drip



drip



trickle



nothing



splash



rush

TOPIC 2.4 · CONTINUED

Sounds for the beginning

Sounds for the end



A stream, running over pebbles.



SEE

🎵 **Scan and see**

What that river looks like written down: hundreds of lines at once.

Look at one page. Find the very top line and the very bottom line. Every one of those lines is one player.

Vltava, the printed score at IMSLP

YOUR TURN

- 1 Read the graphic score above out loud as a class. Big circle, big sound. Empty circle, silence.

VOICE OFF

- 2 Choose five water sounds and write or draw them in an order. Use words, pictures or stones, whatever you like.

TOPIC 2.4 · CONTINUED

- 3 Perform your sequence. Then perform it a second time and try to make it identical.
- 4 Swap sequences with another group and perform theirs. Did it come out the way they meant?
- 5 Move ONE sound in your sequence to a different place. Play it again. What changed?
- 6 Fill in the two trays: which of your sounds work for a beginning, and which work for an ending?

VOICE OFF

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

Sound travels more than four times faster through water than through air. If you put your ear against the side of a full bath and tap it, the sound arrives sooner than you expect.

► ONE STEP MORE

Make your sequence twice as long by adding a silence between every sound. It should feel completely different, and it is the same six sounds.

TOPIC 2.4 · CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Perform your sequence backwards, from the last sound to the first. Decide as a group which direction is better and be able to say why.

♪ KEEP IT

- your five-sound sequence, drawn or written
- the version after you moved one sound, so you can see the change
- a note of which order your group preferred

♪ Words from Topic 2.4

**sequence**

sounds in an order

**order**

what comes first, next and last

**begin**

the very first sound

**end**

the sound that says it is finished



Otto sits alone and very still beside the running stream, both eyes shut, listening to the water.

TOPIC 2.5

Three composers went to the water

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

Otto said that three composers had already done what the band spent last week doing, and had done it rather well.

He was not being unkind. He meant that people have been listening to water and turning it into music for hundreds of years, and that you are allowed to go and hear how they did it.

TOPIC 2.5 · CONTINUED

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ listen to three real pieces about water
- ★ find the water in each one and say how it was made
- ★ use a word from this unit to describe what you heard

A blue circular icon with the words "warm up" in white, stacked vertically.

Sit completely still and silent for thirty seconds. Then name every sound you heard, including the ones that were there the whole time.

Otto asks: what is a layer? And can you have layers in a piece played by only one person?

TOPIC 2.5 • CONTINUED



LISTEN

♪ Scan and listen

The piece your scheme calls
Raindrop: one note repeating underneath everything, like a drip that never stops.

Find the drip. Tap it gently on your knee, all the way through, and do not let it speed up when the music gets louder.

Chopin, Prelude Op. 28 No. 15 (Raindrop), on Wikimedia Commons



LISTEN

♪ Scan and listen

A whole river in music: it starts as two tiny streams and grows.

Listen to the first minute. Show with your hands how wide the river is getting. Stop when you think the two streams have joined.

Smetana, Ma vlast: Vltava (The Moldau), on Wikimedia Commons



LISTEN

♪ Scan and listen

Water made out of a glass instrument and a piano, and nothing else.

One instrument in this piece sounds like light on water. Every time you hear it, open your hand slowly.

Saint-Saens, The Carnival of the Animals: Aquarium, on Wikimedia Commons

TOPIC 2.5 · CONTINUED

 CHOPIN: ONE NOTE THAT WILL NOT STOP

Chopin wrote a piece for piano with a single note repeating all the way through it, underneath everything else. It sounds exactly like a drip that will not stop.

He never called it Raindrop. Somebody else gave it that name afterwards, because of that one repeating note.

 SMETANA: A WHOLE RIVER

Smetana wrote a piece about a real river called the Vltava. It begins with two tiny streams, played by two flutes, and they join together into one big tune, exactly as two streams join into a river.

That is a soundscape and a sequence at once, and it is made of layers. You have done all three of those things this term.

 SAINT-SAENS: LIGHT ON WATER

In Aquarium the shimmering water is made by a glass harmonica, an instrument played by rubbing wet fingers on glass. You made a very similar sound with a wet finger and a bottle rim.

TOPIC 2.5 · CONTINUED

THREE PIECES, THREE KINDS OF WATER

Raindrop one repeating note, like a drip

Vltava two streams joining into a river

Aquarium glass, water and light



The first job of all.

YOUR TURN

- 1 Listen to Raindrop. Find the drip and tap it gently on your knee all the way through, without speeding up when the music gets louder.

VOICE OFF

- 2 Listen to the first minute of Vltava. Show with your hands how wide the river is getting. Stop when you think the two streams have joined.

- 3 Listen to Aquarium. Every time you hear the shimmering instrument, open one hand slowly.

TOPIC 2.5 · CONTINUED

- 4 Choose the piece you liked best and say ONE thing about it using a word from this unit.

VOICE OFF

- 5 One of these three pieces is a place, and two of them are things happening. Decide as a class which is which.

- 6 Make the Aquarium sound yourself: a wet finger drawn slowly round the rim of a glass or a bottle.

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

Chopin never called his famous piece Raindrop. Somebody else gave it that name later, because one note keeps repeating all the way through it, like a drip that will not stop.

TOPIC 2.5 · CONTINUED

► ONE STEP MORE

Listen to Vltava again and count how many times the big river tune comes back. Composers repeat things on purpose, just as you do in an ostinato.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Listen to any one of the three with your eyes shut, and afterwards draw the piece as a shape or a line rather than as a picture. Then explain your drawing.

🎵 Words from Topic 2.5

**composer**

somebody who makes
up music

**orchestra**

a big group of players
together

**river**

water travelling

**audience**

the people listening

TOPIC 2.6

Show us the stream

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

The stream had been running past the rock all term and nobody had really listened to it. Now the whole band could hear about six things in it.

So they played their piece to the hedgerow, with the real stream running underneath the whole performance. Nobody had planned that part. It turned out to be the best bit.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ perform your water piece to an audience
- ★ listen to another group and say something useful about it
- ★ say what you would change if you did it again

warm
up

As a class, make the sound of your whole piece in ten seconds flat, far too fast, just to remind everybody what order it goes in.

TOPIC 2.6 · CONTINUED

Otto asks: what did you keep in your folder from Topic 2.4? Get it out, because you are going to need it.

♪ PERFORMING MEANS DECIDING TO START

The hardest moment in a performance is the one before it. Stand still. Wait for quiet. Look at whoever is counting you in. Then begin **together**.

An audience forgives almost anything except not being able to tell whether you have started.

♪ USEFUL FEEDBACK NAMES ONE THING

Saying it was nice helps nobody. Saying **which layer you could hear best**, or **where the piece grew**, or **that the ending was very clear**, helps enormously.

So use the words from this unit. That is what they are for.

TOPIC 2.6 · CONTINUED

We all started at the same moment.	YES / NO
You could hear every layer.	YES / NO
The piece grew and then got smaller again.	YES / NO
The ending was clear and everybody stopped together.	YES / NO
We played it the same way we had planned it.	YES / NO



Everything goes in, tidy ones and messy ones.



HEAR

🎵 Scan and hear

Real rain, with no music and nobody talking.

Listen with your eyes shut. Then name three different sounds inside the one sound of rain.

The sound of rain, Wikimedia Commons

YOUR TURN

- 1 Perform your water piece to the class. Stand still and wait for quiet before you start.

TOPIC 2.6 · CONTINUED

- 2 Watch another group. Name the layer you could hear most clearly.

VOICE OFF

- 3 Tick the boxes above about your own performance, honestly.

- 4 Say one thing your group did well, and one thing you would change.

- 5 Sing Rain, Rain, Go Away one more time, all together, as the very last thing in the unit.

- 6 Put everything from this unit in your folder, in the order you made it.

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

A composer called Smetana wrote a piece of music about a real river, the Vltava. It begins with two tiny streams played by two flutes, and they join together into one big tune, just as two streams join into a river.

TOPIC 2.6 · CONTINUED

► ONE STEP MORE

Perform your piece for a different class, or for the class next door. A new audience changes how it feels, which is worth noticing.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Perform your piece with the real sound of running water going at the same time, from a tap or a bottle being poured. Your piece has to survive the competition.

♪ KEEP IT

- your water piece, written or drawn, in its final order
- the ticked list above
- one sentence: the best thing about our performance
- one sentence: what we would change next time

TOPIC 2.6 · CONTINUED

🎵 Words from Topic 2.6

**perform**

play it for other people

**feedback**

what a listener tells you

**improve**

make it better than last time

**portfolio**

the folder where you keep your work



The band performs its water piece on the rock while small creatures watch from the wet grass and the stream runs.

END OF UNIT 2

The Stream: what can you do now?

Tick the ones you can do. If a box is empty, that is not a problem: it just tells you what to have another go at.

- ☐ hear more than one sound inside the sound of water
- ☐ make a water sound with my voice, my body and an object
- ☐ name a water sound: drip, trickle, splash, pour
- ☐ sing a whole song using only so and mi
- ☐ show so and mi with my hands while I sing
- ☐ keep my own layer going while other layers come in
- ☐ build a soundscape that grows and then gets smaller
- ☐ put sounds in an order and play them the same way twice
- ☐ listen to a real piece of music and find the water in it
- ☐ say one useful thing about somebody else's performance



Hattie kept her layer going.

END OF UNIT 2 • CONTINUED



The stream, still running past the rock.

How did it go?

Colour one circle for each line. Green for yes, yellow for nearly, orange for not yet.

Hearing the layers in one sound	
Singing so and mi in a whole song	
Keeping my layer going in a soundscape	
Putting sounds into an order	
Listening to Raindrop, Vltava and Aquarium	
Performing to an audience	



The Long Table



Nutkin

owns ti-ti, which is two sounds in one beat.

UNIT 3

The Long Table

Words are already made of rhythm, and you can eat the evidence.

- 1 Say and clap ta, ti-ti and the silent sh.
- 2 Find the rhythm already hiding inside a food word.
- 3 Play a part on five notes you cannot play wrongly.

You will never eat lunch again without noticing the rhythm hiding in it.

THE SIX TOPICS IN THIS UNIT

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| 1 Ta, ti-ti, and the sound of nothing | 2 Every food word has a rhythm |
| 3 A pattern that will not stop | 4 Five notes, one long table |
| 5 Play it, hear it, mend it | 6 Looking back at the Long Table |

TOPIC 3.1

Ta, ti-ti, and the sound of nothing



Bramble taps a steady pulse on the flat stone, Nutkin claps twice as fast, and Tessa holds up a paw for silence.

♪ OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

Nutkin could not sit still, so Bramble gave him a job: clap twice for every one of Bramble's taps.

It worked perfectly for about nine seconds. Then Nutkin sped up, because Nutkin always speeds up. Tessa fixed it by holding up one paw for a whole beat, and in that beat of silence everybody found each other again.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ say and clap ta, ti-ti and sh
- ★ hear that ti-ti is two sounds inside one beat
- ★ keep a beat of silence without losing the pulse

TOPIC 3.1 • CONTINUED



Count to four out loud, over and over, and clap on every number. Now clap TWICE on every number. Do not let the counting speed up.

🎵 THREE WORDS FOR THREE THINGS

From today you have three words for what happens in one beat.

ta is one sound that fills the beat. **ti-ti** is two sounds squeezed into the same beat. **sh** is a beat where you make no sound at all.

They are not new. You have been doing all three since Unit 1. They just did not have names yet.

🎵 SH IS NOT A GAP: IT IS A BEAT

This is the part everybody gets wrong at first. A **sh** is not a pause and it is not a rest from working. It is a beat, exactly as long as a **ta**, and you have to **count it**.

The pulse never stops. Only the sound does.

TOPIC 3.1 • CONTINUED

🎵 **THE PULSE KEEPS GOING UNDERNEATH ALL OF IT**

Whatever you are clapping, the pulse underneath stays the same. That is why the pulse and the rhythm are two different things, and why you can put any rhythm on top of the same pulse.

FOUR TA. ONE SOUND IN EVERY BEAT

4

4



ta ta ta ta

FOUR TI-TI. TWO SOUNDS IN EVERY BEAT, EIGHT IN ALL

4

4



ti ti ti ti ti ti ti ti

TOPIC 3.1 • CONTINUED

THREE TA AND A SH. COUNT THE SILENCE OUT LOUD

4

4

| | | z

ta ta ta sh

FEEL ALL FOUR BEATS, BUT ONLY PLAY ON 1 AND 3

1

2

3

4



Sticks in the earth: two joined together are a ti-ti.



READ

🎵 Scan and read

What musicians mean by the pulse, and why it is not the same as rhythm.

Ask your teacher to read the first paragraph. Then find your own pulse in your wrist and count it out loud.

Pulse in music, Wikipedia

TOPIC 3.1 • CONTINUED

YOUR TURN

- 1 Say ta ta ta ta while clapping. Then say ti-ti ti-ti ti-ti ti-ti while clapping. The clapping gets faster; the counting does not.

ta ta ta ta

VOICE OFF

- 2 Read the third card above out loud, including the sh. Say the word sh, do not just go quiet.

ta ta ta sh

- 3 Clap the third card but only THINK the sh. The silence has to be exactly the right length.

- 4 In pairs: one keeps a steady pulse, the other claps ti-ti on every beat. Then swap.

- 5 Your teacher claps a four-beat pattern of ta and ti-ti. Clap it back.

- 6 Play the third card on an instrument. Everybody must stop dead on the sh.

TOPIC 3.1 • CONTINUED

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

Pulse and rhythm are not the same thing. The pulse is the steady counting underneath, and the rhythm is the pattern of long and short sounds you put on top of it.

► ONE STEP MORE

Clap four ti-ti while walking four steady steps. Your feet do ta and your hands do ti-ti, at the same time.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Two beats of sh in a row, in the middle of a pattern. Almost everybody comes back in too early, so count them out loud in your head.

TOPIC 3.1 • CONTINUED

♪ Words from Topic 3.1

**ta**

one sound in one beat

**ti-ti**

two sounds in one beat

**sh**

a beat with no sound

**rest**

a silence you still count

**beat**

one tap of the pulse



An apple, a pear and blackberries in a row along the flat stone, with Nutkin chanting and Hattie clapping.

TOPIC 3.2

Every food word has a rhythm

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

Hattie noticed something at breakfast and could not stop thinking about it.

The word **apple** has two claps in it. The word **bread** has one. Nobody put them there on purpose. The rhythm was already inside the words, waiting, and once you can hear it you cannot stop hearing it.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ clap the syllables in a food word
- ★ match a food word to ta or ti-ti
- ★ put food words together to fill four beats



Clap your own name. How many claps? Now clap the name of the person next to you.

TOPIC 3.2 · CONTINUED

Otto asks: how many sounds are there in a ti-ti? And how many beats?

 WORDS ARE ALREADY MADE OF BEATS

Every word is built out of little pieces called **syllables**, and you can hear them by clapping.

bread is one clap, so it is a **ta**. **ap-ple** is two claps in the time of one beat, so it is a **ti-ti**. **ba-na-na** is three, which takes a ti-ti and a ta together.

 ADDING WORDS UP TO FOUR BEATS

Here is where it gets useful. If apple is one beat and bread is one beat, then apple bread apple bread is **four beats exactly**: a whole bar.

So you can build a rhythm out of your lunch, and it will always add up, as long as you count.

TOPIC 3.2 • CONTINUED

🎵 A CHANT IS A RHYTHM YOU SAY

A **chant** is words said in rhythm, all together, without a tune. It is the oldest music there is, and it is how you will learn every rhythm in this unit.

Hot Cross Buns

Hot cross buns! Hot cross buns!
One a penny, two a penny,
Hot cross buns!

Say it and clap it. Hot cross buns is three claps: ta ta ta. Then **one a pen-ny, two a pen-ny** is much faster, all ti-ti.



bread

ta • 1 beat



ap ple

ti ti • 1 beat



ba na na

ti ti ta • 2 beats



wa ter me lon

ti ti ti ti • 2 beats

TOPIC 3.2 · CONTINUED

APPLE BREAD APPLE BREAD: FOUR BEATS EXACTLY

4

4



ap ple bread ap ple bread

BANANA CHEESE PEAR: ALSO FOUR BEATS

4

4



ba na na cheese pear

WATERMELON SOUP PEAR: STILL FOUR BEATS

4

4



wa ter me lon soup pear

TOPIC 3.2 • CONTINUED



READ

🎵 Scan and read

The word you have been using all unit, explained by musicians. Ask your teacher to read the first paragraph and then say, in your own words, the difference between pulse and rhythm.

Rhythm, Wikipedia

YOUR TURN

- 1 Clap each of the four food words on the cards. Say how many claps each one has.

VOICE OFF

- 2 Read the first rhythm card out loud with the words underneath it, clapping as you go.
ap-ple bread ap-ple bread

- 3 Choose four food words that add up to exactly four beats. Write them down.

TOPIC 3.2 · CONTINUED

- 4 Chant your four words while a partner keeps the pulse. Did they add up?

VOICE OFF

- 5 Play your four words on an instrument instead of saying them.

- 6 Sing Hot Cross Buns, then chant it and clap the syllables. Watch out for the fast bit.

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

Every word is already made of beats. We call them syllables, and you can hear them by clapping a word: ap-ple has two claps and ba-na-na has three.

► ONE STEP MORE

Find a food word with FOUR syllables that is not watermelon. Clap it, then work out which sticks you would need to write it.

TOPIC 3.2 • CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Build a four-beat bar that uses a sh in it, so one of your four beats is a food word nobody says. Chant it with the silence in the right place.

♪ Words from Topic 3.2

**syllable**

one clap inside a word

**chant**

words said in rhythm

**apple**

two claps: ti-ti

**bread**

one clap: ta

**banana**

three claps

TOPIC 3.3

A pattern that will not stop

♪ OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

*Bramble found a pattern he liked and played it again.
And again. And again.*

Nutkin asked when he was going to play something else. Bramble said never, that was the whole idea, and then Nutkin played something different on top of it and discovered that Bramble had been right all along.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ make up a short pattern and repeat it exactly
- ★ keep your pattern going while somebody plays another one
- ★ put three patterns together so they line up



Bramble shakes a short pattern over and over with his eyes shut while Nutkin lays a different one over the top.

**warm
up**

Make up a four-beat clapping pattern. Do it four times without changing it at all. That is harder than it sounds.

TOPIC 3.3 • CONTINUED

Otto asks: in Unit 2 you built a storm out of layers. What was the one thing all the layers had to share?

♪ A PATTERN THAT WILL NOT STOP HAS A NAME

A short pattern repeated over and over underneath a piece of music is called an **ostinato**. The word comes from an old Italian word meaning **stubborn**, which is exactly right.

An ostinato is not lazy. It is the thing that holds a piece together while more interesting things happen on top of it.

♪ SHORT IS BETTER THAN LONG

A good ostinato is **four beats** and no more. If it is longer than that you will not remember it, and if you cannot remember it you cannot keep it going while somebody talks to you.

TOPIC 3.3 · CONTINUED

🎵 **THREE AT ONCE, AND WHY THEY FIT**

Look at the three parts below. They are completely different from each other. Every single one of them is **four beats long**.

That is the only rule. If one group played a three-beat pattern, it would slip one beat further out every bar, and after four bars nobody would know where anybody was.

Three ostinatos at once. All four beats long, so they line up every single bar

Bramble
tambourine



soup ap ple bread cheese

4
TIMES

Nutkin
seed-pod shaker



ap ple hon ey pear sh

4
TIMES

Tessa
big low drum



por ridge bread cheese

4
TIMES

TOPIC 3.3 • CONTINUED



A stem curled round so it comes back to the start.



A tambourine.



READ

🎵 Scan and read

The proper name for a pattern that will not stop, with famous examples.

Your teacher will read you the meaning. Then clap your own ostinato four times without changing it at all.

Ostinato, Wikipedia

YOUR TURN



Safe ears. Three groups of instruments repeating for a long time gets loud without anybody deciding to be loud. Play so you can hear the other two parts. If you cannot hear them, you are too loud.

- 1 Chant Bramble's part four times without stopping, then SING it on so and mi instead of chanting it.

soup ap-ple bread cheese

SING IT

TOPIC 3.3 • CONTINUED

- 2 Chant Nutkin's part four times. It ends on a sh, so count the silence.

VOICE OFF

- 3 Half the class does Bramble's part and half does Nutkin's, at the same time. Count yourselves in together.

- 4 Add Tessa's part as a third group. Three ostinatos at once.

- 5 Make up your own four-beat ostinato out of food words. Repeat it four times.

- 6 Put your ostinato against your partner's. Do they line up? If not, count the beats in each one and find out why.

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

A pattern that repeats and repeats underneath a piece of music has a proper name: an ostinato. The word comes from an old Italian word meaning stubborn, which is exactly what it is.

TOPIC 3.3 • CONTINUED

► ONE STEP MORE

Keep your ostinato going while your teacher asks you a question, and answer it without stopping. That is what a real player has to do.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Three groups, three ostinatos, and one group drops out for four beats and comes back in exactly on time.

♪ Words from Topic 3.3

**ostinato**

a pattern that repeats

**repeat**

do the same thing again

**layer**

one part of several at once

**part**

your own bit of the music

TOPIC 3.4

Five notes, one long table

warm
up

Play the five notes one after another, going up. Now going down. Now in any order at all, one note per beat.



Five wooden bars of different lengths laid along the flat stone, with Pip striking one and Hattie waiting.

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

Badger took two of the bars away before anybody arrived.

Nutkin thought that was very unfair, until he realised he could hit any of the five that were left, in any order, with his eyes shut, and it always sounded good. Badger had not taken something away. He had taken the wrong notes away.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ play a part on five tuned notes
- ★ hear that no order of these five sounds wrong
- ★ play your part with the group, on the beat

TOPIC 3.4 • CONTINUED

 FIVE NOTES INSTEAD OF SEVEN

A normal set of notes has seven in it before it starts again. This one has **five**. Two of them, f and b, have been taken out.

The proper name for a set of five notes is a **pentatonic** scale. Penta is an old Greek word for five.

 WHY TAKING NOTES AWAY HELPS

It sounds backwards, but it is true: with these five notes, you cannot play a wrong one. Any order works. Any two together work.

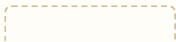
That means you can concentrate entirely on **when** to play, which is the hard part, instead of worrying about **what** to play.

 PUTTING THE TUNE ON THE RHYTHM

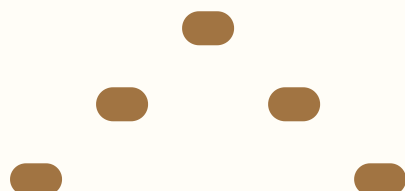
You already know how to make a four-beat rhythm. Now put a note on each sound of it, choosing from the five. That is a real melody, and you made it.

TOPIC 3.4 • CONTINUED

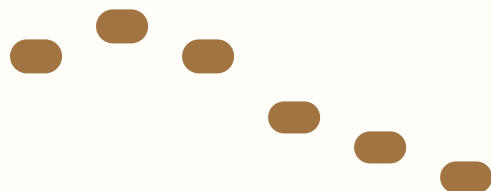
THE FIVE NOTES ON THE LONG TABLE

						
C	D	E	F	G	A	B
doh	ray	mi	taken away	so	la	taken away

FIVE NOTES GOING OUT AND COMING BACK



NOW ALL THE WAY DOWN. SING IT AS YOU PLAY IT



TOPIC 3.4 · CONTINUED

A tune and a pulse, four beats each**Pip**

ukulele and voice

| | ||| |
 ta ta ti ti ta

4

TIMES

Bramble

tambourine

| z | z
 ta sh ta sh

4

TIMES



Five bars, longest to shortest.



READ

🎵 Scan and read

Why taking two notes away makes an instrument easier to play, not harder.

Ask your teacher to read you the first sentence. Then count how many notes are left when two are taken away from seven.

Pentatonic scale, Wikipedia

TOPIC 3.4 • CONTINUED

YOUR TURN

- 1 Play all five notes in order, one per beat, and SING each one as you play it. Your voice learns the notes faster than your hands do.

SING IT

- 2 Play any five notes you like, one per beat. Then play five completely different ones. Both worked, did they not?

- 3 Take a four-beat rhythm from Topic 3.2, put one of the five notes on each sound, and sing it before you play it.

- 4 Sing your five notes as well as playing them. Use so and mi if it helps you find them.

- 5 Two players at once, both choosing freely from the five notes, on the same pulse. Listen to what you made together.

- 6 Play Pip's part above while another group plays Bramble's. Count in first.

TOPIC 3.4 • CONTINUED

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

A pentatonic scale has five notes instead of seven. Two notes have been taken away on purpose, and that is what makes it so hard to play anything that sounds wrong.

► ONE STEP MORE

Play your part starting on a different one of the five notes. It will sound different and it will still work, which is the whole point of a pentatonic set.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Four players, four different pentatonic parts, all four beats long, all at once, and nobody conducting.

♪ Words from Topic 3.4

**pentatonic**

five notes, with two taken away

**xylophone**

wooden bars you hit

**together**

at the same moment

**part**

your own bit of the music



Two groups face each other across the long stone, one playing and the other listening with heads tilted.

TOPIC 3.5

Play it, hear it, mend it

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

The first performance was too fast, too loud and over in four seconds.

Otto did not say it was bad. He said one thing: he could not hear Hattie. So they played it again with Hattie louder and everything else softer, and it turned into a completely different piece. One sentence from a listener had done that.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ perform your ostinato piece to another group
- ★ say one useful thing about what you heard
- ★ change one thing and play it again

TOPIC 3.5 • CONTINUED



Play your group's ostinato once, far too fast, then once far too slowly, then once at the speed you actually want.

Otto asks: what has to be the same about three ostinatos if they are going to fit together?



LISTEN

♪ **Scan and listen**

Fourteen short pieces, each one a different animal.

Choose any one piece. Listen to it twice and decide which animal it is before you look at the name.

Saint-Saens, The Carnival of the Animals, complete, on Wikimedia Commons

♪ **PLAYING IT, HEARING IT AND MENDING IT ARE THREE JOBS**

You cannot really hear your own part while you are playing it. Your hands are busy and your ears are full of the thing right next to them.

That is why you need somebody **listening**. They can hear the whole thing at once, which you genuinely cannot.

TOPIC 3.5 • CONTINUED

🎵 USEFUL FEEDBACK NAMES ONE THING

Saying it was good helps nobody at all. Try one of these instead:

I could not hear ...

the pattern changed when ...

the best bit was ...

you all stopped together

somebody sped up at ...

One thing. Then the group can actually do something about it.

🎵 MENDING ONE THING AT A TIME

Change **one** thing, then play it again. If you change four things at once you will never know which one helped.

Here is a real mend. The first version is all ti-ti and it turns into a blur. The second one takes some of the sounds out, and suddenly you can hear the shape.

TOPIC 3.5 · CONTINUED

BEFORE: EVERY BEAT CROWDED, ALL TI-TI

4

4

ti ti ti ti ti ti ti ti

AFTER: FEWER SOUNDS, AND NOW IT HAS A SHAPE

4

4

ti ti ta ti ti sh



The same pattern, coming back round.

We all started at the same moment.	YES / NO
You could hear every part.	YES / NO
Nobody sped up.	YES / NO
We stopped together at the end.	YES / NO
We played it the same way twice.	YES / NO

TOPIC 3.5 • CONTINUED



Somebody has to be listening.

YOUR TURN

- 1 Perform your group's ostinato piece to another group. Stand still and wait for quiet first.
- 2 Listen to their piece. Name ONE thing, using one of the sentence beginnings above.
VOICE OFF
- 3 Take the one thing you were told and change it. Only that one thing.
- 4 Play it again. Ask the same group whether it is better.
- 5 Chant the two rhythm cards above one after the other. Which one can you hear more clearly, and why?
- 6 Tick the list above about your own group, honestly.

TOPIC 3.5 • CONTINUED

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

People have always sung while doing hard jobs together, like hauling ropes or grinding corn. The song keeps everybody pulling at the same moment, which makes the work easier.

► ONE STEP MORE

Perform your piece with one player deliberately missing. Whoever is listening has to work out which part is gone.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Play your piece, take feedback, change one thing, and perform it again, all within five minutes. Real musicians do this all day.

♪ Words from Topic 3.5

**feedback**

what a listener tells you

**improve**

make it better than last time

**perform**

play it for other people

**together**

at the same moment

TOPIC 3.6

Looking back at the Long Table

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

At the end of the unit Nutkin said the thing he liked best was that the rhythm had been in the words the whole time and nobody had told him.

Otto said that was the correct thing to like. Everything in music is already somewhere, waiting, and the work is learning to notice it.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ read and clap a four-beat rhythm on your own
- ★ write a rhythm down so somebody else can play it
- ★ put your best work in your folder



Clap the rhythm of four food words while your partner guesses which four they were.

Otto asks: what is the difference between the pulse and the rhythm? You have known this since Topic 3.1.

TOPIC 3.6 • CONTINUED

🎵 WHAT YOU CAN DO NOW

Six weeks ago ta, ti-ti and sh were not words. Now you can say them, clap them, read them off a page and write them down.

You can also hear that **ap-ple** is a ti-ti, which means you will never again be able to eat lunch without noticing the rhythm in it. Sorry about that.

🎵 WRITING IT DOWN IS WHAT KEEPS IT

A pattern you only remember lasts until you forget it. A pattern you have written down lasts as long as the paper does, and somebody who has never met you can play it.

That is why the sticks matter. They are not a test. They are a way of keeping something you made.

READ THIS ONE AND CLAP IT. MIND THE SH

4

4

| ||| | z

ta ti ti ta sh

TOPIC 3.6 · CONTINUED

AND THIS ONE. THE LAST SOUND IS HELD FOR TWO BEATS

4

4



ti ti ta ta a

NOW WRITE YOUR OWN. FOUR BEATS, AND NO MORE

1

2

3

4



Everything goes in.



LISTEN

🎵 Scan and listen

A famous fast dance played absurdly slowly, because it is a tortoise.

This is a fast tune played slowly on purpose. Walk to it, as slowly as it goes, and try not to fall over.

Saint-Saens, The Carnival of the Animals: Tortues, on Wikimedia Commons

TOPIC 3.6 • CONTINUED

- 1 Read and clap the first card on your own, out loud, including the sh.

ta ti-ti ta sh

VOICE OFF

- 2 Read and clap the second card. Hold the last sound for two whole beats.

- 3 Write your own four-beat rhythm in the boxes, using ta, ti-ti and sh.

- 4 Swap with a partner and clap each other's. Did yours come out the way you meant it?

- 5 Play your rhythm on five pentatonic notes, and sing it at the same time.

SING IT

- 6 Listen to Tortues. It is a fast dance played absurdly slowly. Walk to it, as slowly as it goes.

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

The crunch you hear when you eat a crisp is much louder inside your own head than it is to anybody else. The sound travels straight through the bones of your skull to your ears.

TOPIC 3.6 • CONTINUED

► ONE STEP MORE

Write a rhythm that takes TWO bars, so eight beats altogether. Draw a line between the two bars so a reader knows where the second one starts.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Write a four-beat rhythm, hide it, clap it three times, and see whether a partner can write down what you clapped.

♪ KEEP IT

- every rhythm you wrote in this unit, in the boxes and on paper
- your group's ostinato from Topic 3.3
- the food words you found that were not in the book
- one sentence: the rhythm I am proudest of, and why

TOPIC 3.6 • CONTINUED

🎵 Words from Topic 3.6

**rhythm**

the pattern of long and short

**pulse**

the steady beat underneath

**portfolio**

the folder where you keep your work

**porridge**

two claps: ti-ti



The long stone cleared and tidy after the meal, with the instruments in a neat row and Otto looking along them.

END OF UNIT 3

The Long Table: what can you do now?

Tick the ones you can do. If a box is empty, that is not a problem: it just tells you what to have another go at.

- ☐ say and clap ta, ti-ti and sh
- ☐ count a beat of silence without losing the pulse
- ☐ clap the syllables in a food word
- ☐ match a food word to ta or ti-ti
- ☐ put food words together to fill exactly four beats
- ☐ make up an ostinato and repeat it without changing it
- ☐ keep my ostinato going while two other parts play
- ☐ play a part on five pentatonic notes
- ☐ read a four-beat rhythm off the page and clap it
- ☐ write a rhythm down so somebody else can play it



Nutkin found the rhythm in his lunch.

END OF UNIT 3 • CONTINUED



The instruments, laid out for putting away.

How did it go?

Colour one circle for each line. Green for yes, yellow for nearly, orange for not yet.

Saying and clapping ta, ti-ti and sh	
Counting the silence on a sh	
Clapping the syllables in a word	
Keeping an ostinato going	
Playing five pentatonic notes with a group	
Reading and writing a four-beat rhythm	

UNIT 4

The Turning Day

The same tune can be bright or shadowy, and you choose which.

- 1 Hear whether music is bright or shadowy, and say why.
- 2 Write a rhythm down in sticks so somebody else can play it.
- 3 Play the same thing softly and strongly, on purpose.

You will play one tune two ways, and choose which of them is the shadowy one.

THE SIX TOPICS IN THIS UNIT

- 1 Bright music and shadowy music
- 3 Move the way the music moves
- 5 Loud, soft, and everything between

- 2 Writing rhythm down with sticks
- 4 Four beats, and what you put in them
- 6 Looking back at the Turning Day



The Turning Day



Tessa

owns slow, low and long, and the shadowy half.

TOPIC 4.1

Bright music and shadowy music



Two halves of the same hedgerow: the left warm and sunlit with Pip in it, the right cool and shadowed with Tessa.

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

Badger played two pieces of music and asked which one was the daytime one.

Everybody got it right immediately, and nobody could explain how they knew. That is worth noticing: your ears worked it out before your mouth could say why.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ hear that music can sound bright or shadowy
- ★ point at where a piece sits between the two
- ★ say how a piece of music made you feel

warm
up

Sing one note as brightly as you can, with a big smile. Now sing the same note as gloomily as you can. Same note, two different worlds.

TOPIC 4.1 • CONTINUED

♪ BRIGHT AND SHADOWY ARE REAL THINGS YOU CAN HEAR

Some music sounds like sunshine and some sounds like a dark corner. Almost everybody agrees which is which, even people who have never had a music lesson.

Nobody is completely sure **why** we all agree. That is a real mystery, not a thing your teacher is keeping from you.

♪ IT IS NOT THE SAME AS LOUD AND SOFT

Shadowy music can be very loud. Bright music can be very quiet. Do not mix these two up: **bright and shadowy** is about the **colour** of the sound, and **loud and soft** is about the **size** of it.

♪ POINTING COMES BEFORE EXPLAINING

It is hard to say in words how music makes you feel. It is much easier to **point**. So use the bar: put your finger where you think the piece belongs, and then try to say why.

TOPIC 4.1 • CONTINUED

bright



One scene, cut down the middle.

shadowy



Otto, against the moon.



LISTEN

🎵 Scan and listen

Bright, bony, rattling music, with a xylophone being a skeleton. Is this bright music or shadowy music? Point to your answer on the light and dark line, then say which instrument told you.

Saint-Saens, The Carnival of the Animals: Fossiles, on Wikimedia Commons

YOUR TURN

- 1 Listen to Fossiles. Point at the bar: is it bright or shadowy? Say which instrument told you.

VOICE OFF

TOPIC 4.1 • CONTINUED

- 2 Sing one note brightly, then shadowily. Ask a partner to say which was which with their eyes shut.

SING IT

- 3 Your teacher plays two short pieces. Point at the bar for each one. Does the whole class agree?

- 4 Find one word of your own for shadowy music. Not sad, not scary: your own word.

- 5 Play something bright on an instrument. Then play something shadowy on the same instrument. What did you change?

- 6 Sit still with your eyes shut through a whole shadowy piece and then say one thing you pictured.

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

Music built on a minor scale usually strikes listeners as darker or sadder than music built on a major one. Almost everybody agrees about the feeling, even though it is only a small change in the notes.

TOPIC 4.1 • CONTINUED

► ONE STEP MORE

Play the same five pentatonic notes twice, once brightly and once shadowily. The notes cannot change, so work out what else you can change.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Find a piece of music that is bright and shadowy at DIFFERENT times, and point at the moment it turns.

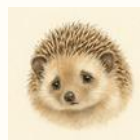
♪ Words from Topic 4.1

**bright**

sounds like sunshine

**shadowy**

sounds like a dark corner

**feeling**

what the music does to you

**day**

the light half

**night**

the dark half



Hattie draws short upright marks in soft earth with a stick while Bramble taps each one in turn.

TOPIC 4.2

Writing rhythm down with sticks

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

Hattie invented a piece on Monday and by Wednesday she *had* completely forgotten it.

So on Thursday she scratched it into the earth with a stick before she forgot it again: a mark for every sound, joined up where two sounds shared a beat. On Friday she played it back perfectly, and it was still Hattie's piece.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ read a rhythm written in sticks
- ★ write your own rhythm in sticks
- ★ hold a sound for three whole beats

TOPIC 4.2 · CONTINUED



Clap ta ti-ti ta sh twice. Now write it in the air with one finger, one mark per sound.

Otto asks: how do you write two sounds that share one beat? And what mark do you use for a beat with no sound at all?

♪ STICKS ARE THE SHORTEST WAY TO WRITE A SOUND

One upright mark is one sound. Two marks joined across the top are a **ti-ti**: two sounds in one beat. A rest gets its own mark, because a silence you have to count is worth writing down.

No noteheads, no five lines. Just the rhythm, which is the part you need right now.

♪ A NEW ONE: A SOUND HELD FOR THREE BEATS

You know **ta**, one beat, and **ta-a**, two beats. Now you get **ta-a-a**, which is **three** beats of one single sound.

Say it out loud: ta a a. Three counts, one sound. Then one more beat of something else fills the bar.

TOPIC 4.2 · CONTINUED

🎵 **READING IS NOT THE SAME AS COPYING**

When you copy a clapped pattern you are using your ears. When you read one off the page you are using your eyes, and you can do it without ever having heard it.

That is the whole point of writing music down. Somebody who has never met you can play the thing you made.

READ IT, THEN CLAP IT. THE LAST BEAT IS SILENT

4

4



ta ti ti ta sh

FOUR QUICK ONES, THEN A SOUND HELD FOR TWO BEATS

4

4



ti ti ti ti ta a

TOPIC 4.2 • CONTINUED

NEW: ONE SOUND HELD FOR THREE BEATS, THEN A TA

4

4



ta a a ta

THE SILENCE IS IN THE MIDDLE THIS TIME

4

4



ta sh ti ti ta



Marks in the earth. Two joined are a ti-ti.



READ

🎵 Scan and read

How people have written sound down, going back thousands of years.

Ask your teacher to show you the oldest picture on this page. Then write your own four beats in sticks and see if a friend can clap it.

Musical notation, Wikipedia

TOPIC 4.2 · CONTINUED

YOUR TURN

- 1 Read the first card out loud and clap it, saying sh on the silent beat.

ta ti-ti ta sh

VOICE OFF

- 2 Read the third card. Hold the first sound for three whole counts. Most people let go too early.

ta a a ta

- 3 Clap the fourth card. The silence is in the middle, which is much harder than a silence at the end.

- 4 Write one of the four cards down from memory after your teacher covers it.

- 5 Play the second card on five pentatonic notes, singing the notes with it.

SING IT

- 6 Invent a four-beat rhythm, write it in sticks, and give it to a partner to play.

TOPIC 4.2 • CONTINUED

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

The letters p and f in music are short for Italian words: piano meaning soft and forte meaning strong. Musicians have been writing them for hundreds of years.

► ONE STEP MORE

Write a rhythm that uses ta-a-a and a sh in the same four beats. There is only one way to do it, so work out what it must be.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Your teacher claps a four-beat pattern once only. Write it down in sticks from that single hearing.

♪ Words from Topic 4.2

**stick notation**

rhythm written as marks

**write it down**

keeping it so it lasts

**bar**

one set of four beats

**rest**

a silence you still count

TOPIC 4.3

Move the way the music moves

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

Badger put on a piece of music and told everybody to move the way it moved. Nobody was allowed to make a single sound.

Nutkin bounced. Tessa barely moved at all. Both of them were right, because the music had a bouncy bit and a heavy bit, and they had each chosen a different one to be.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ move the way a piece of music moves
- ★ change how you move when the music changes
- ★ choose your movement on purpose, not just anything



Nutkin leaps high and light in the sunlit half while Tessa moves low and slow through the shadowed half.

TOPIC 4.3 • CONTINUED



Walk about the room in time with the music. When it stops, freeze. Nobody speaks at all.

Otto asks: in Topic 4.1, what was the difference between bright and loud?

♪ YOUR BODY ALREADY KNOWS THE ANSWER

Put on bouncy music and you will bounce without deciding to. Put on heavy music and you will slow down. Your body works out what music is doing faster than your words can.

So this topic is not about dancing well. It is about **listening with your whole self** and then noticing what you did.

♪ EXPRESSIVE CHOICES MEANS YOU CHOSE

There is a difference between wandering about and **choosing** to move low and slowly because the music is shadowy.

The choice is the musical part. Anyone can move; a musician moves **because of something they heard**, and can say what it was.

TOPIC 4.3 • CONTINUED

♪ THE MOMENT IT TURNS

The most interesting moment in a piece is the one where it changes: bright to shadowy, fast to slow, loud to soft.

Catch that moment with your body and everybody watching will hear it too.

move high and light

move low and slow

HOW FAST IS IT, REALLY?

 **very slow** 52 to 60 beats a minute

 **slow** 60 to 76 beats a minute

 **walking** 76 to 100 beats a minute

 **quick** 100 to 126 beats a minute



Two ways of moving, in the same hedgerow.

TOPIC 4.3 • CONTINUED



LISTEN

🎵 Scan and listen

The same Raindrop piece as Unit 2, but this time listen to its middle: it goes dark, and then the light comes back.

Put your hand up when the music turns dark, and put it down again when it turns back to the light.

Chopin, Prelude Op. 28 No. 15, performed by Giorgi Latsabidze, on Commons

YOUR TURN

- 1 Move to the music with no sound at all. Freeze when it stops.
VOICE OFF
- 2 Listen to the Raindrop piece again. Put your hand up when it turns dark and down again when the light comes back.
- 3 Half the class moves bright and half moves shadowy, to the same piece, at the same time.
- 4 Choose one way of moving and be able to say which sound made you choose it.
- 5 Move to the music, then play an instrument the same way you moved.

TOPIC 4.3 • CONTINUED

- 6 Move at exactly the speed on the tempo ladder your teacher points at. Then swap and point for the class.

VOICE OFF

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

There is a whole kind of music named after the night. It is called a nocturne, and it is usually quiet, slow and thoughtful, the way the world is when it is dark.

► ONE STEP MORE

Move to the music with only ONE part of you: just your hands, or just your head. Small movements are much harder to keep honest.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Move to a piece you have never heard before, and change the moment it changes, with nobody telling you when.

♪ Words from Topic 4.3

**move**

travel with the music

**still**

not moving at all

**expression**

putting feeling into it

**calm**

quiet and unhurried

TOPIC 4.4

Four beats, and what you put in them

**warm
up**

Count to four and clap only on beat 1. Then only on beats 1 and 3. Then on all four. Never lose the counting.



Four shallow hollows in the stone in a row, with Bramble dropping a pebble into some and leaving others empty.

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

Bramble found four hollows in the rock, in a line, and started putting pebbles in them.

One pebble in each was boring. Two pebbles crowded into one hollow was interesting. An empty hollow was the most interesting of all, because everybody leaned in to hear the thing that was not there.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ build a rhythm inside exactly four beats
- ★ use ta, ti-ti, sh and a held sound in the same bar
- ★ put your bar against another group's bar

TOPIC 4.4 • CONTINUED

Otto asks: what happens to two groups if one has a four-beat pattern and the other has a three-beat pattern?

♪ FOUR BEATS IS A BOX YOU FILL

A bar of four beats is a box. You can put anything you like in it as long as it **adds up to four**.

One ta is one beat. One ti-ti is one beat, with two sounds in it. One sh is one beat of nothing. A ta-a is two beats and a ta-a-a is three.

♪ READ THREE THAT ALREADY ADD UP

Look at the three examples. Every one of them fills four beats exactly, and every one sounds completely different.

♪ EMPTY BEATS ARE THE BEST ONES

Beginners fill every beat, and it turns into a blur. Leave a beat **empty** and the audience leans in.

A rhythm with a silence in the middle of it is nearly always more interesting than one without.

TOPIC 4.4 • CONTINUED

EXAMPLE 1: ADDS UP TO FOUR

4

4



ta ta ti ti ta

EXAMPLE 2: A SILENCE ON BEAT THREE

4

4



ti ti ta sh ta

EXAMPLE 3: A HELD SOUND, THEN TWO QUICK ONES

4

4



ta a ti ti ta

TOPIC 4.4 • CONTINUED

YOUR BAR. FILL IT, AND MAKE IT ADD UP TO FOUR

1

2

3

4

Two four-beat bars against each other. Count in together

Bramble

tambourine

ta ta ti ti ta

4
TIMES

Nutkin

seed-pod shaker

z

ti ti ta sh ta

4
TIMES



SEE

🎵 Scan and see

The actual page the pianist reads, with the repeating drip written out.

Find Prelude 15. Look for the one note that repeats all the way down the page. That is the raindrop, written down.

Chopin's Preludes, Op. 28: the printed score at IMSLP

TOPIC 4.4 • CONTINUED

YOUR TURN

- 1 Clap all three examples one after another. Count out loud between them.

VOICE OFF

- 2 Fill the four boxes with your own rhythm. Check that it adds up to four before you play it.

- 3 Clap your bar four times without changing it.

- 4 Sing your bar to your partner on so and mi, then play both bars together, counting in as one.

SING IT

- 5 Play the two-part example above as two groups. Then swap parts.

- 6 Change one beat of your bar into a sh. Play it again. Better or worse?

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

The piano is named after being quiet. Its full old name meant soft and loud, because unlike the instruments before it, you could play it both ways just by changing your fingers.

TOPIC 4.4 • CONTINUED

► ONE STEP MORE

Make your bar into TWO bars, eight beats altogether, where the second bar is the first one with one thing changed.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Four groups, four different four-beat bars, all at once, with nobody conducting. If it falls apart, count out loud and start again.

♪ KEEP IT

- your four-beat bar, written in sticks
- the two-bar version from One step more, if you got that far
- one sentence: which beat you left empty, and why

♪ Words from Topic 4.4

**four beats**

one full bar

**bar**

the box the beats go in

**compose**

make up your own

**sh**

a beat with no sound



The band playing strongly with mouths wide open on the left, and the same band playing very gently on the right.

TOPIC 4.5

Loud, soft, and everything between

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

Nutkin's answer to everything was louder.

Badger let him do it once, at full volume, and then made the whole band play the same piece as softly as it could manage. The soft one was better, and Nutkin was honest enough to say so.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ play the same thing loudly and softly on purpose
- ★ read the letters p and f
- ★ choose how loud a piece should be, and say why

warm
up

Say your own name as softly as you can without whispering. Now say it strongly, without shouting. Those are the two you need.

TOPIC 4.5 • CONTINUED

Otto asks: is a high note the same thing as a loud note?
You worked this out in Unit 1.



READ

♪ Scan and read

The two letters p and f, and what musicians have used them for since 1600.

Ask your teacher to find the letters p and f. Then play one note p and the same note f, and let the class say which was which.

Dynamics in music, Wikipedia

♪ TWO LETTERS, AND THEY ARE ITALIAN

Musicians write two letters to say how loud to play. **p** is short for *piano*, which is Italian for soft. **f** is short for *forte*, which means strong.

They have been writing them for hundreds of years, in every country, so you are learning the real thing and not a version for children.

TOPIC 4.5 • CONTINUED

♪ SOFT IS HARDER THAN LOUD

Anybody can be loud. Playing genuinely softly, together, without anybody drifting, is one of the hardest things a group can do.

It is also where all the best playing happens, because an audience has to lean in to hear it.

♪ GETTING LOUDER AND GETTING SOFTER

You do not have to stay at one level. A piece can **grow** from *p* to *f*, or **fade** from *f* to *p*, and that is often the most expressive thing in it.

You did this already in Unit 2, when the storm grew and passed.

p**soft**

play it gently

f**loud**

play it strongly

TOPIC 4.5 · CONTINUED

HOW LOUD, AND WHAT IT COSTS

 **p** soft: the audience leans in

 **between** your normal playing

 **f** strong: but never a bang



p, soft

f, strong

YOUR TURN



Safe ears. f means strong, not as hard as you can hit it. Play so you can still hear the person next to you, and never play f for more than a few bars at a time. If your ears ring or feel odd, stop and tell your teacher straight away.

- 1 Sing one note p, then the same note f, then play it both ways. Let the class say which was which.

SING IT

- 2 Say a food-word chant p, then f, then p again, all in one go.

VOICE OFF

- 3 Play your bar from Topic 4.4 twice: once p and once f. Same rhythm, two different pieces.

TOPIC 4.5 • CONTINUED

4 As a class, grow from p to f over eight counts, then fade back over eight more. Nobody may jump.

5 Sing a so-mi song p all the way through. Softly is much harder than loudly.

SING IT

6 Decide as a group whether your piece should be p or f, and be able to say why in one sentence.

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

Bats hunt in the dark by shouting and listening. Most of the shouts are too high for you to hear at all, which is why a bat seems silent when it is actually being very loud.

► ONE STEP MORE

Play something so softly that the person at the far side of the room can only just hear it. Then ask them whether they could.

TOPIC 4.5 • CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Grow from p to f and back again while keeping the pulse absolutely steady. Almost everybody speeds up as they get louder.

♪ Words from Topic 4.5

**dynamics**

how loud or soft

**loud**

a big sound

**soft**

a small sound

**getting louder**

growing towards f

**getting softer**

fading towards p

TOPIC 4.6

Looking back at the Turning Day

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

At the end of the unit the light went, and nobody suggested playing anything.

They sat on the rock in the dark and listened instead. Otto said that was a perfectly good way to end a unit about light and dark, and for once nobody argued with him.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ look back at what you learned about light and dark
- ★ read and play a rhythm with a held sound in it
- ★ say how you want a piece to sound, using p and f



Sing Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star, softly, all together, with no instruments at all.

Otto asks: what do p and f stand for, and which language are they?

TOPIC 4.6 • CONTINUED

 THE SAME NOTES, TWO DIFFERENT PIECES

The big idea of this unit is that you did not need new notes to make something new. You changed how **bright** it was, how **loud** it was, and how it **moved**. Same notes, different piece.

That is what musicians mean by **expression**, and it is entirely your choice, every time you play.

 A SONG FOR THE DARK HALF

The words of this one were written as a poem by Jane Taylor in 1806, and the tune is an older French one. They were put together afterwards, by somebody else.

Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star

Twinkle, twinkle, little star,
How I wonder what you are.
Up above the world so high,
Like a diamond in the sky.
Twinkle, twinkle, little star,
How I wonder what you are.

Sing it p. It is a night-time song and it does not want to be shouted.

TOPIC 4.6 • CONTINUED

CAN YOU STILL READ THIS? HOLD IT FOR THREE

4

4

| _ _ |

ta a a ta

AND THIS ONE, WITH THE SILENCE IN THE MIDDLE

4

4

|| | z |

ti ti ta sh ta



The moon, clear of the hedgerow.



READ

🎵 **Scan and read**

The words musicians use for fast and slow, and the numbers behind them.

Ask your teacher for the number beside the word walking. Then walk to it, as a class, all together.

Tempo, Wikipedia

TOPIC 4.6 • CONTINUED

YOUR TURN

- 1 Read and clap both rhythm cards above, on your own. VOICE OFF
- 2 Sing Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star p, then sing one line of it f. Which suited the song?
- 3 Point at the bright and shadowy bar for a piece your teacher plays, and say one word about how it felt.
- 4 Play your four-beat bar from Topic 4.4 one last time, choosing p or f on purpose.
- 5 Move to a piece of music with no sound, changing when it changes.
- 6 Tidy your folder. Put the rhythms you wrote in the order you wrote them.

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

The words of Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star were written as a poem by Jane Taylor in 1806. The tune is an older French one, and the two were put together afterwards.

TOPIC 4.6 • CONTINUED

► ONE STEP MORE

Sing Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star starting shadowy and turning bright halfway through. You will have to decide exactly where the turn happens.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Play a piece where the rhythm never changes but the dynamics do, and see whether a listener can describe what happened.

♪ KEEP IT

- every rhythm you wrote in this unit
- your four-beat bar, with p or f marked on it
- one sentence: a piece of music that felt shadowy, and why
- one sentence: the thing I want another go at

TOPIC 4.6 • CONTINUED

♪ Words from Topic 4.6

**night**

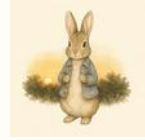
the dark half

**moon**

the light in the dark

**expression**

putting feeling into it

**sunrise**when the light comes
back

The hedgerow at dusk, the last light going, the whole band sitting quietly together with instruments resting.

END OF UNIT 4

The Turning Day: what can you do now?

Tick the ones you can do. If a box is empty, that is not a problem: it just tells you what to have another go at.

- ☐ hear whether music is bright or shadowy
- ☐ point at where a piece sits between bright and shadowy
- ☐ say how a piece of music made me feel
- ☐ read a rhythm written in sticks
- ☐ write my own rhythm in sticks
- ☐ hold one sound for three whole beats
- ☐ build a rhythm that adds up to exactly four beats
- ☐ leave a beat empty on purpose
- ☐ play the same thing p and f
- ☐ move the way the music moves, and say why I chose it



Tessa held the long notes.

END OF UNIT 4 • CONTINUED



The turn of the day, in one picture.

How did it go?

Colour one circle for each line. Green for yes, yellow for nearly, orange for not yet.

Hearing bright and shadowy	
Reading a rhythm in sticks	
Writing a rhythm in sticks	
Filling four beats exactly	
Playing p and f on purpose	
Moving the way the music moves	



The Big Rock



Badger

owns the signal, and he decides when you begin.

UNIT 5

The Big Rock

Everything you kept this year, given away in one afternoon.

- 1 Choose your best work out of a whole year of it.
- 2 Sing one note while somebody next to you sings another.
- 3 Perform to a real audience, and finish together.

You will stand on the rock, in front of everybody, and give the whole year away.

THE SIX TOPICS IN THIS UNIT

- | | |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| 1 Choose the best of the year | 2 Add a part, and then take one away |
| 3 Write our own celebration song | 4 Who does what, and when |
| 5 The dress rehearsal | 6 The Big Rock concert |

TOPIC 5.1

Choose the best of the year



The whole band round an open grass folder on the rock, every animal pointing at a different sheet at once.

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

Badger emptied the folder out onto the rock. A whole year came out of it.

There was the animal piece from the autumn, and the storm, and about nine food-word rhythms, and one sheet nobody could identify at all. Choosing took much longer than anybody expected, because everything in the pile had somebody's favourite on it.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ look back through everything you made this year
- ★ choose the pieces you want to perform
- ★ say why a piece is worth choosing

TOPIC 5.1 • CONTINUED



Sing the first line of every song you can remember from this year. Do not finish any of them.

🎵 THIS IS WHAT THE FOLDER WAS FOR

All year you have been putting things in a folder, including the messy ones. Today is the day it pays off.

You cannot choose your favourite piece if you have forgotten what you made. That is why keeping things matters: not to be tidy, but so that today is possible.

🎵 HOW TO CHOOSE

Three questions, and they are the ones real musicians ask.

can we actually play it?

do we enjoy it?

will it sound good to somebody else?

A piece has to pass all three. The hardest piece you know is not the best one to perform if you can only just manage it.

TOPIC 5.1 • CONTINUED

🎵 REVISING MEANS PLAYING IT AGAIN, BETTER

To **revise** a piece is to go back to it and improve it. Not to start again: to take what is already there and make it cleaner, clearer or more expressive.

☐

A piece we can definitely play

☐

A piece we all enjoy

☐

A piece with layers in it

☐

A song we can all sing from memory

☐

One thing we made up ourselves



A whole year, tipped out on the rock.

TOPIC 5.1 • CONTINUED



LISTEN

🎵 Scan and listen

The most famous celebration music in the world, sung by hundreds of people at once.

Listen for the moment the singing starts. Put your hand up then. Notice how long the music waits before it lets them in.

Beethoven, Symphony No. 9, finale, on Wikimedia Commons

YOUR TURN

- 1 Get your folder out and lay everything from this year in front of you.

VOICE OFF

- 2 Choose the three pieces you would most like to perform. Number them.

- 3 For each one, say which of the three questions it passes best.

TOPIC 5.1 • CONTINUED

- 4 Play one of your chosen pieces straight through, exactly as it was.
- 5 Now play it again and make ONE thing cleaner. That is revising.
- 6 Sing one song from memory, with no words in front of you. **SING IT**

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

Beethoven wrote his most famous celebration music when he was almost completely deaf. He could not hear the choir that sang it.

► ONE STEP MORE

Find the oldest sheet in your folder and play what is on it. It will be easier than you remember, which is the proof that you have got better.

TOPIC 5.1 • CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Choose a piece nobody in your group picked first, and make a case for it in three sentences.

♪ KEEP IT

- your list of three chosen pieces, numbered
- the reason you chose each one

♪ Words from Topic 5.1

**celebration**

a day made for music

**choose**

pick on purpose

**favourite**

the one you like best

**revise**

go back and improve it



Pip sings and plays while Bramble adds a tambourine part and Tessa a slow low drum underneath: three layers.

TOPIC 5.2

Add a part, and then take one away

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

The song was fine on its own. Then Bramble added a beat, and it was better.

So Nutkin added a busy part, and it was better again. So Hattie added another, and Tessa another, and suddenly nobody could hear the song at all. They took three parts away and it was the best it had ever been.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ add a percussion part to a song you know
- ★ sing two notes at once with a partner
- ★ take a part away when there are too many

TOPIC 5.2 · CONTINUED



Sing a song you know. Half the class taps the pulse on their knees while the other half sings. Then swap.

Otto asks: what has to be true about two parts if they are going to fit together? You learned this with the *ostinatos*.

♪ **ADDING A PART IS EASY. KNOWING WHEN TO STOP IS THE SKILL**
Every part you add makes a piece bigger. After about four, each new one makes it **worse**, because the parts start hiding each other. So the real question is not what else can we add. It is **what can we take away**.

♪ **FOUR PARTS THAT DO DIFFERENT JOBS**

Look at the four parts below. Tessa holds one long sound for the whole bar. Bramble keeps the plain pulse. Nutkin is busy. Pip has the tune.

Four different jobs. That is why they fit: nobody is doing somebody else's job.

TOPIC 5.2 · CONTINUED

🎵 **HARMONY: TWO NOTES AT THE SAME MOMENT**

When you sing **so** and a friend sings **mi** at exactly the same moment, the two of you have made **harmony**.

You cannot make harmony on your own. It is the one musical thing in this whole book that needs somebody else, which is why it belongs at the end of the year.

Four parts: a held sound, a pulse, a busy part and a tune

Tessa

big low drum

| _ _ _
ta a a a

4

TIMES

Bramble

tambourine

| | | |
ta ta ta ta

4

TIMES

Nutkin

seed-pod shaker

▬ | ▬ |
ti ti ta ti ti ta

4

TIMES

Pip

ukulele and voice

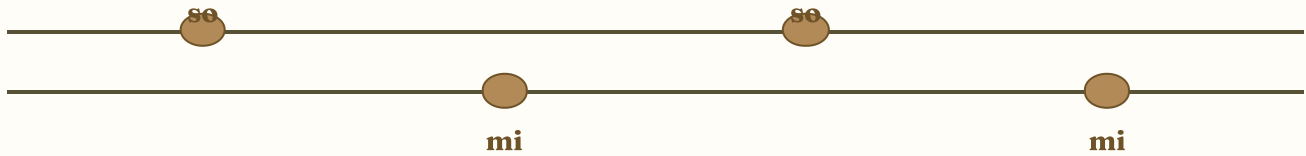
| | ▬ |
ta ta ti ti ta

4

TIMES

TOPIC 5.2 · CONTINUED

ONE HALF SINGS THE SO, THE OTHER THE MI. HOLD THEM BOTH

*p***soft**

play it gently

*f***loud**

play it strongly



READ

 Scan and read

What happens when two different notes are sung at the same moment.

Ask your teacher to read the first sentence. Then sing so while a friend sings mi, at the same time, and listen to what the two of you made.

Harmony, Wikipedia

YOUR TURN



Safe ears. Four parts with instruments is the loudest this book gets. Play so you can hear the singers, because if you cannot hear them, the audience certainly cannot. Stop the moment your teacher raises a hand.

TOPIC 5.2 · CONTINUED

- 1 Sing your chosen song while one group taps the plain pulse underneath.

SING IT

- 2 Add a second percussion part. Now there are three things happening.

- 3 Add a fourth. Then decide honestly whether it is better or worse.

- 4 Take one part away. Which one did the piece not need?

- 5 Half the class sings *so* and holds it. The other half sings *mi* and holds it. Listen to what you made together.
so ... and mi ...

- 6 Play all four parts above as four groups, then take Nutkin's part out and play it again.

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

Harmony is what happens when two different notes sound at the same moment. One person cannot make harmony alone, which is why it belongs at the end of this book.

TOPIC 5.2 · CONTINUED

► ONE STEP MORE

Swap parts with another group so you are playing something you did not practise. Everybody should be able to play everybody's part.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Sing your song in two halves, one on so and one on mi, while a third group keeps the pulse. Three things at once, all from voices and hands.

🎵 Words from Topic 5.2

**harmony**

two notes at the same moment

**add**

put another part in

**take away**

remove a part

**percussion**

things you hit, shake or scrape

TOPIC 5.3

Write our own celebration song

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

Badger said the band should have a song of its own, and nobody knew how to start.

Pip said the words first. Bramble said the rhythm first. They tried it both ways round and discovered they were both right, because the words already had a rhythm in them, which is a thing this class found out in Unit 3.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ make up words for a short celebration song
- ★ put a tune on your words using five notes
- ★ learn your own song well enough to sing it from memory



The whole band making up a new song together, every mouth open on the same words, Badger keeping them together.

TOPIC 5.3 • CONTINUED



Chant your own class name in rhythm, four times, until everybody is saying it exactly together.

Otto asks: which five notes can you not play a wrong note with? And why is that?



START WITH THE WORDS, BECAUSE THEY BRING THEIR OWN RHYTHM

Say what you want the song to be about, out loud, in the plainest words you can. Then **clap what you just said**. The rhythm is already there.

You have known this since the food words: **ap-ple** is a ti-ti whether anybody writes it down or not.



THEN PUT THE FIVE NOTES ON IT

Take your rhythm and give each sound one of the five pentatonic notes. Any of them. If it sounds odd, choose a different one, but nothing will sound **wrong**.

Sing it. If you can sing it twice the same way, you have written a song.

TOPIC 5.3 · CONTINUED

🎵 SHORT AND REPEATED BEATS LONG AND CLEVER

A good class song is **two bars** long and repeats. Everybody can learn it in one go, everybody remembers it next week, and a hundred people can sing it at once.

That is what you want on the day. Not clever: **together**.

TWO BARS. SAY YOUR WORDS, THEN CLAP THIS, THEN JOIN THEM

4

4



ta ta ti ti ta ta ta ta sh

FIVE NOTES ON EIGHT SOUNDS. SING IT



TOPIC 5.3 • CONTINUED

- 1 Say what the song is about, in plain words.
- 2 Clap the words. That is your rhythm, and it was free.
- 3 Put one of the five notes on every sound.
- 4 Sing it twice the same way. Now it exists.



Bunting, up early.



HEAR

🎵 Scan and hear

Real bells, rung to tell a whole town that something is beginning.

Count how many different bells you can hear. Then invent your own four-beat signal for the beginning of your concert.

Cathedral bells at Fribourg ringing, on Wikimedia Commons

YOUR TURN

- 1 As a class, decide in one sentence what your song is about.

VOICE OFF

TOPIC 5.3 • CONTINUED

2 Say the sentence out loud together, then clap its rhythm. VOICE OFF

3 Choose five pentatonic notes and put one on each sound of your rhythm. SING IT

4 Sing your song twice, exactly the same way both times.

5 Teach your song to somebody who was not in the room.

6 Invent a four-beat signal to start the song, like the bells in the recording.

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

When a group of people sing together, their breathing falls into step with the music and with each other. Singing in a choir is something your whole body joins in with.

► ONE STEP MORE

Write a second verse using the same tune and different words. That is exactly how most songs in the world were made.

TOPIC 5.3 • CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Make up your song without writing anything down, then teach it to another class entirely from memory.

♪ KEEP IT

- the words of your class song
- its rhythm, written in sticks
- which five notes you used

♪ Words from Topic 5.3

**compose**

make up your own

**words**

what the song says

**tune**

the shape the song makes

**part**

your own bit of the music

TOPIC 5.4

Who does what, and when

**warm
up**

Walk on, stand still, wait for silence, bow, walk off. No music at all. Do it twice.



Badger on the rock pointing at each animal in turn while they wait in a line with their instruments ready.

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

The music was ready a week before the concert. Nothing else was.

Nobody knew who walked on first, where to stand, who held Tessa's beater while she climbed up, or what to do if somebody forgot. So Badger wrote a list, and the list turned out to be as important as the music.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ work out the order your pieces go in
- ★ know your own job and when it happens
- ★ practise the joins between pieces, not just the pieces

TOPIC 5.4 • CONTINUED

Otto asks: in Unit 2 you learned what the first and last sounds of a piece are for. What was that?

♪ THE RUNNING ORDER IS THE PLAN

A **running order** is a list of what happens, in order, from walking on to walking off. It is not being fussy. It is what stops eleven people standing about looking at each other.

Put the piece you are most sure of **first**. Confidence is catching, and so is panic.

♪ THE JOINS ARE THE HARD PART

Every group can play its pieces. Almost no group can get from the end of one to the start of the next without a long confusing gap.

So practise the **joins**: the last note of one piece, the moving about, and the first note of the next. Practise them more than the pieces themselves.

TOPIC 5.4 • CONTINUED

 EVERYBODY HAS A JOB, INCLUDING THE LISTENERS

Somebody gives the signal. Somebody carries the drum. Somebody counts in. Somebody tells the audience what is coming next.

Nobody in a performance has nothing to do.

☐

Walk on and stand still

☐

Wait for the room to go quiet

☐

Badger gives the signal

☐

First piece: the one we are surest of

☐

Move to our places for the second piece

☐

Second piece

☐

Our own class song, last

☐

Bow, and walk off together

TOPIC 5.4 • CONTINUED

Jobs before we start

Jobs during the concert



One raised paw. Everybody watches it.



READ

🎵 **Scan and read**

How one person keeps a hundred players together using only their hands.

Ask your teacher to read you one paragraph. Then take turns to conduct four beats while the class plays.

Conducting, Wikipedia

YOUR TURN

- 1 Write your running order out, in order, from walking on to walking off.

VOICE OFF

- 2 Fill in the two trays: who does what before, and who does what during.

TOPIC 5.4 • CONTINUED

- 3 Practise walking on and standing still. Do it until it is quiet and quick.

VOICE OFF

- 4 Practise ONE join: the last note of one piece to the first note of the next. Do it four times.

- 5 Take turns to be the one who gives the signal. Four beats, clearly.

- 6 Run the whole order through with no music, just moving to the right places.

 OTTO'S TRUE THING

A conductor makes no sound at all. Their whole job is to keep everybody together and to show how loud, how fast and how gentle the music should be, using only their hands.

 ONE STEP MORE

Decide what you will do if somebody forgets their part in the middle. Every real band has a plan for this, and it is never stopping.

TOPIC 5.4 • CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Run the whole concert order through with nobody speaking at all, using only signals.

♪ KEEP IT

- your running order, written out
- your own job, written down where you will not lose it

♪ Words from Topic 5.4

**running order**

what happens, in order

**job**

the thing you are responsible for

**cue**

the signal that it is your turn

**rehearse**

practise the whole thing



A full dress rehearsal with the bunting up and nobody watching, the band playing to an empty patch of grass.

TOPIC 5.5

The dress rehearsal

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

The dress rehearsal went wrong in four separate places, and Badger was delighted.

He said that was exactly what a dress rehearsal is for. Every one of those four things would have gone wrong tomorrow instead, in front of everybody, and now none of them will.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ run the whole concert through without stopping
- ★ keep going when something goes wrong
- ★ listen back to yourselves and fix the last few things



Play the first four beats of your first piece. Stop. Do it again. Again. Until the start is perfect.

TOPIC 5.5 · CONTINUED

Otto asks: what is the *hardest* moment in a performance? You were told this in Unit 2.



HEAR

♪ **Scan and hear**

A real audience clapping, which is the sound your own concert will end on.

Listen to how applause starts, grows, and dies away. Practise clapping like that: it is a sound you make on purpose too.

[Applause on Wikimedia Commons](#)

♪ **A DRESS REHEARSAL IS THE REAL THING WITH NOBODY WATCHING**

Everything exactly as it will be: the running order, the standing still, the bows, the joins. The only difference is the empty grass.

Do not stop to fix things. Write them down and fix them **afterwards**, because stopping is the one thing you cannot do tomorrow.

TOPIC 5.5 • CONTINUED

 WHEN IT GOES WRONG, KEEP GOING

Something will go wrong. A player will come in early, or somebody will drop a beater, or two groups will start at once.

Keep going. An audience barely notices a wrong note. They notice everybody stopping and staring at each other.

 LISTENING BACK

If you can record yourselves, do. You will hear things you could not possibly hear while playing, because your hands were busy.

It is the same lesson as Topic 3.5, and it is the last new thing in this book: you cannot hear your own playing properly from the inside.

TOPIC 5.5 · CONTINUED

We started together, without anybody speaking.	YES / NO
Nobody stopped in the middle.	YES / NO
You could hear the singers over the instruments.	YES / NO
The joins between pieces were quick and quiet.	YES / NO
We finished together and then stood still.	YES / NO
We bowed, and we did not run off.	YES / NO



Everything ready, and nobody watching yet.

YOUR TURN

- 1

Run the whole concert from walking on to walking off, without stopping for anything.
- 2

Tick the list above honestly, straight afterwards, before you forget.

VOICE OFF
- 3

Choose the ONE thing that most needs fixing. Fix only that.

TOPIC 5.5 • CONTINUED

4 Run it again. Just the parts either side of the thing you fixed.

5 Listen to the applause recording. Notice how it starts, grows and dies away. Practise clapping like that.

VOICE OFF

6 Practise the very last moment: the final note, the silence, and the bow.

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

Clapping to say thank you is very old indeed. Audiences in ancient Rome clapped, and so did audiences long before that.

► ONE STEP MORE

Record your dress rehearsal and listen to it with your eyes shut. Name one thing you could not hear while you were playing.

TOPIC 5.5 • CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Have your teacher deliberately make something go wrong in the middle, and keep going anyway. That is the whole skill.

♪ KEEP IT

- the ticked list from your dress rehearsal
- the one thing you fixed, and whether it worked

♪ Words from Topic 5.5

**dress****rehearsal**

the real thing, with no audience

**record**

keep the sound of it

**rehearse**

practise the whole thing

**cue**

the signal that it is your turn

TOPIC 5.6

The Big Rock concert

🎵 OUT IN THE HEDGEROW

They played on the big rock, in the afternoon, with the bunting up and the whole hedgerow watching.

Otto did not listen from the side. For the first time all year he stood with the band, and he did not play anything, because listening had been his part the entire time and he was not about to give it up now.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ perform your concert to a real audience
- ★ finish the year knowing what you can do
- ★ complete your folder and be proud of it



Stand still together. Breathe in together. Wait for the room. That is the whole warm up.

TOPIC 5.6 · CONTINUED

Otto asks: what is the very first thing you learned in this book? It was in Unit 1, and it was about listening.

♪ THIS IS THE GIVING-AWAY PART

All year you have made sounds on purpose and then **kept** them: in your head, on two lines, in sticks, in your folder.

Today you give them away. That is the last step, and it is the reason for all the others.

♪ WHAT YOU CAN DO NOW THAT YOU COULD NOT IN SEPTEMBER

You can sing two notes and name them. You can read a rhythm off a page and write one down. You can keep your own part going while three other parts happen. You can build a piece out of layers, put it in order, and choose whether it is loud or soft, bright or shadowy.

None of that was true a year ago.

TOPIC 5.6 • CONTINUED

★ THE BIG GIVE-AWAY

Everybody in the class has a job, and every job is on the running order from Topic 5.4.

Walk on. Stand still. Wait for the room to be quiet, however long that takes. Watch whoever is giving the signal.

Play your pieces in the order you decided, with the joins you practised. If something goes wrong, keep going: you rehearsed that too.

Finish your class song together. Hold the silence for a moment before you move. Then bow, all at the same time, and walk off together.

Then listen to the applause. You made that.



The Big Rock concert.

TOPIC 5.6 · CONTINUED



LISTEN

🎵 Scan and listen

The end of the whole Carnival, where every animal comes back at once.

Every animal from the piece returns in this last movement. Listen out for one you remember, and shout its name when it goes past.

Saint-Saens, The Carnival of the Animals: Final, on Wikimedia Commons

YOUR TURN

- 1 Perform your concert, all the way through, to a real audience.
- 2 Hold the silence at the very end before anybody moves. VOICE OFF
- 3 Bow together, and walk off together.
- 4 Afterwards, say one thing that went better than you expected.
- 5 Sing your class song one final time, to yourselves, with nobody listening.
- 6 Finish your folder. Put everything in, in order, and write your name on the front.

TOPIC 5.6 • CONTINUED

♪ OTTO'S TRUE THING

Saint-Saens would not let his *Carnival of the Animals* be published while he was alive, in case people thought he was not a serious composer. It is now the piece he is most famous for.

➤ ONE STEP MORE

Perform your concert a second time for a different audience. It will be completely different, and you will be much better at it.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Teach one whole piece from your concert to a class younger than you. Teaching it is the proof that you really know it.

♪ KEEP IT

- everything, in order, from the whole year
- your running order and your job from the concert
- your class song, words and rhythm
- one sentence: the best moment of the concert
- one sentence: what I want to learn next year

TOPIC 5.6 • CONTINUED

🎵 Words from Topic 5.6

**concert**

playing for an audience

**applause**

the sound of thank you

**proud**

pleased with what you did

**portfolio**

the folder where you keep your work



The final concert: the whole band on the rock under the bunting, with a crowd of small creatures clapping below.

END OF UNIT 5

The Big Rock: what can you do now?

Tick the ones you can do. If a box is empty, that is not a problem: it just tells you what to have another go at.

- ☐ look back through my folder and choose my best pieces
- ☐ say why a piece is worth performing
- ☐ add a percussion part to a song
- ☐ know when to take a part away
- ☐ sing so while somebody else sings mi
- ☐ make up words and a tune for a short song
- ☐ learn my own song well enough to sing it from memory
- ☐ know my job in a performance and when it happens
- ☐ keep going when something goes wrong
- ☐ perform to a real audience and finish together



Badger gave the signal.

END OF UNIT 5 • CONTINUED



The Hedgerow Band, at the end of the year.

How did it go?

Colour one circle for each line. Green for yes, yellow for nearly, orange for not yet.

Choosing and revising a piece	☐ ☐ ☐
Adding and taking away parts	☐ ☐ ☐
Singing harmony with a partner	☐ ☐ ☐
Making up our own song	☐ ☐ ☐
Knowing my job in the running order	☐ ☐ ☐
Performing to a real audience	☐ ☐ ☐

THE SONGBOOK

Every song in this book

All of these are old. Every one of them was sung by children long before you were born, and the words are old enough that anybody may print them.

Underneath each one is where it came from, so you can see that somebody checked.

Rain, Rain, Go Away

*Rain, rain, go away,
Come again another day.*

Unit 1. English. First published 17th century or earlier. A true SO-MI song: the whole tune sits on two notes, which is why it opens the pitch work in this book. Recorded from the 17th century or earlier, so the text is long out of copyright. Set from the common oral version, which is the two lines above and nothing more; the longer variants are later additions and are not printed.

THE SONGBOOK • CONTINUED

Star Light, Star Bright

Star light, star bright,
First star I see tonight,
I wish I may, I wish I might,
Have the wish I wish tonight.

Unit 1. American, sung throughout Britain. First published 1880s. Late nineteenth century and comfortably out of copyright. Another two-note so-mi chant in most classroom versions, which is why it appears in Unit 1 and returns in Unit 4 with the night songs.

Bee, Bee, Bumble Bee

Bee, bee, bumble bee,
Stung a man upon his knee,
Stung a pig upon his snout,
I declare that you are out.

Unit 1. English playground rhyme. First published traditional. A traditional playground counting-out chant with no known author, sung on so and mi. Set from the common oral version. It is printed because a so-mi unit needs more than one song a class can already almost sing.

THE SONGBOOK

Snail, Snail

Snail, snail, snail, snail,
Round and round and round.

Unit 1. English playground rhyme. First published traditional. A traditional two-note game song, author unknown, set from the common oral version. Its whole melody is so and mi, and its words are slow, which makes it the song Tessa the tortoise leads.

Row, Row, Row Your Boat

Row, row, row your boat,
Gently down the stream,
Merrily, merrily, merrily, merrily,
Life is but a dream.

Unit 2. American, sung throughout Britain. First published 1852. First printed in 1852 and long out of copyright. It is in this unit because it is the round every Year 2 class can manage, and a round is the simplest true experience of layering.

A Sailor Went to Sea

A sailor went to sea, sea, sea,
To see what he could see, see, see,
But all that he could see, see, see,
Was the bottom of the deep blue sea, sea, sea.

Unit 2. English clapping song. First published traditional. A traditional clapping song with no known author, set from the common oral version. Printed here for its steady pulse and its repeated words, which is the pairing the water unit needs before the soundscapes.

THE SONGBOOK

Hot Cross Buns

Hot cross buns! Hot cross buns!
One a penny, two a penny,
Hot cross buns!

Unit 3. English street cry. First published 1798 or earlier. An eighteenth-century London street cry, printed by the 1790s and long out of copyright. The most useful food song in the book: its words fall into ta and ti-ti exactly, so the rhythm work in topic 3.2 can be done on a song the class already knows.

Pat-a-cake, Pat-a-cake

Pat-a-cake, pat-a-cake, baker's man,
Bake me a cake as fast as you can.
Pat it and prick it and mark it with B,
And put it in the oven for baby and me.

Unit 3. English. First published 1698. One of the oldest recorded English nursery rhymes, appearing in a play of 1698. Set from the common oral version. Its syllables are so regular that it doubles as the clapping game for the pulse work.

Polly Put the Kettle On

Polly put the kettle on,
Polly put the kettle on,
Polly put the kettle on,
We'll all have tea.

Unit 3. English. First published 1803. Printed from 1803 and out of copyright. The repeated line is an ostinato in everything but name, which is why it sits beside topic 3.3.

THE SONGBOOK

Pease Porridge Hot

Pease porridge hot, pease porridge cold,
Pease porridge in the pot, nine days old.
Some like it hot, some like it cold,
Some like it in the pot, nine days old.

Unit 3. English. First published 1760. Recorded from about 1760 and out of copyright. A clapping game whose text is built out of food words, which is precisely what topic 3.2 asks for.

Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star

Twinkle, twinkle, little star,
How I wonder what you are.
Up above the world so high,
Like a diamond in the sky.
Twinkle, twinkle, little star,
How I wonder what you are.

THE SONGBOOK • CONTINUED

Unit 4. English words, French tune. First published 1806. The words are Jane Taylor's poem The Star, published in 1806, and the tune is the older French melody Ah! vous dirai-je, maman. Both are out of copyright. Mozart wrote variations on the tune and did not compose it, so his name is not attached to it here.

I See the Moon

I see the moon,
And the moon sees me.
God bless the moon,
And God bless me.

Unit 4. English. First published traditional. A traditional rhyme with no known author, set from the common oral version. In the book it is offered as the quiet song for the dark half of the Turning Day, and a class may sing it or say it.

THE SONGBOOK

When the Saints Go Marching In

Oh, when the saints go marching in,
Oh, when the saints go marching in,
Oh, how I want to be in that number,
When the saints go marching in.

Unit 5. American gospel. First published 1896 (early published forms). A gospel hymn whose early published forms date from the 1890s, out of copyright. Printed here because its four lines repeat, so a whole class can learn it in one session and add percussion parts to it in the next.

Auld Lang Syne

Should auld acquaintance be forgot,
And never brought to mind?
Should auld acquaintance be forgot,
And auld lang syne?

For auld lang syne, my jo,
For auld lang syne,
We'll tak a cup o' kindness yet,
For auld lang syne.

Unit 5. Scots, Robert Burns. First published 1788. Robert Burns set this down in 1788 and it has been out of copyright for well over a century. The first verse and chorus only: that is what a class actually sings, and it is the song the book ends the year on.

THE SONGBOOK

Songs we did not print, and why

Some songs are not printed in this book, and it is worth knowing why. A song belongs to whoever made it up. If somebody wrote the words in the last hundred years or so, then printing them in a book you can buy is not ours to do, even when everybody already knows the song.

Your teacher can still sing all of these with you. Singing a song and printing it in a book are two different things.

♪ IT'S RAINING, IT'S POURING

1912 (first two lines), recorded 1939. American. NOT PRINTED.

The obvious rain song for this unit, and the reason this file exists. Its first two lines are traceable only to The Little Mother Goose, published in the United States in 1912, and the rhyme as a whole is recorded from 1939. That is far too recent for a priced book to reproduce, however old the tune feels. Teachers may of course sing it with a class, and the book names it so they can.

THE SONGBOOK · CONTINUED

♪ KUM BA YAH

earliest known recording 1926. African American spiritual, disputed. TUNE ONLY, WORDS NOT PRINTED. The authorship is genuinely disputed, with rival claims and an earliest known recording of 1926. Where authorship is contested, the safe reading is that somebody may hold a claim, so the melody may be sung and the text is not reproduced here.

♪ HAPPY BIRTHDAY TO YOU

melody 1893, familiar text later. American. NOT PRINTED. The most famous rights history in music: the familiar text was subject to a disputed claim for decades, settled in the United States in 2015 and 2016, and the position still differs between territories. A school singing it in a classroom and a publisher printing it in a priced book are not in the same position, and this book is the publisher.

THE SONGBOOK · CONTINUED

♪ FOR HE'S A JOLLY GOOD FELLOW

tune 18th century French, English text later. English. TUNE ONLY. The melody is the old French Malbrough s'en va-t-en guerre and is out of copyright, but the familiar English text has no single clear pre-1930 published source that could be verified, so it is not printed.

This is a real decision that real publishers make, and we have shown you ours rather than quietly leaving the songs out.

WORD BOOK

All the words you learned

99 words, from A to Z. Beside each one is where you met it, so you can go back and look.

add to compose



add

put another part in



applause

the sound of thank you



apple

two claps: ti-ti



audience

the people listening



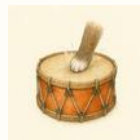
banana

three claps



bar

one set of four beats



beat

one tap of the pulse



begin

the very first sound



bread

one clap: ta



bright

sounds like sunshine



calm

quiet and unhurried



celebration

a day made for music



chant

words said in rhythm



choose

pick on purpose



chorus

everybody singing at once



compose

make up your own

WORD BOOK

🎵 composer to four beats



composer

somebody who makes
up music



concert

playing for an audience



copy

do it exactly the same



cue

the signal that it is your
turn



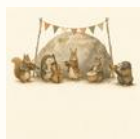
dawn

the very start of the
day



day

the light half



dress

rehearsal

the real thing, with no
audience



drip

one drop landing



dynamics

how loud or soft



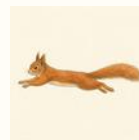
end

the sound that says it is
finished



expression

putting feeling into it



fast

hurrying



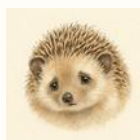
favourite

the one you like best



feedback

what a listener tells you



feeling

what the music does to
you



four beats

one full bar

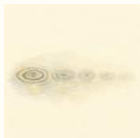
WORD BOOK

♪ getting louder to move



getting louder

growing towards f



getting softer

fading towards p



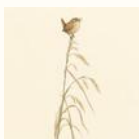
hand sign

showing a note with
your hand



harmony

two notes at the same
moment



high

a fast wobble



improve

make it better than last
time



improvise

make it up as you go



instrument

a thing made for making
sound



job

the thing you are
responsible for



layer

sounds happening at
the same time



listen

the first job of all



loud

a big sound



low

a slow wobble



mi

the lower of the two
notes



moon

the light in the dark



move

travel with the music

WORD BOOK

 night to repeat
**night**

the dark half

**orchestra**

a big group of players together

**order**

what comes first, next and last

**ostinato**

a pattern that repeats

**part**

your own bit of the music

**pentatonic**

five notes, with two taken away

**percussion**

things you hit, shake or scrape

**perform**

play it for other people

**porridge**

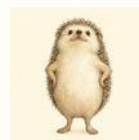
two claps: ti-ti

**portfolio**

the folder where you keep your work

**pour**

water tipped out

**proud**

pleased with what you did

**pulse**

the steady beat underneath

**record**

keep the sound of it

**rehearse**

practise the whole thing

**repeat**

do the same thing again

WORD BOOK

🎵 rest to steady

**rest**

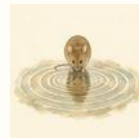
a silence you still count

**revise**

go back and improve it

**rhythm**

the pattern of long and short

**ripple**

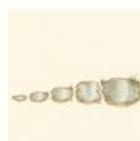
rings spreading on water

**river**

water travelling

**running order**

what happens, in order

**sequence**

sounds in an order

**sh**

a beat with no sound

**shadowy**

sounds like a dark corner

**slow**

taking your time

**so**

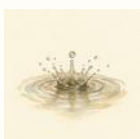
the higher of the two notes

**soft**

a small sound

**soundscape**

a place made of sound

**splash**

water hit hard

**stave**

the lines music is written on

**steady**

always the same speed

WORD BOOK

♪ stick notation to whisper



stick notation

rhythm written as
marks



still

not moving at all



sunrise

when the light comes
back



syllable

one clap inside a word



ta

one sound in one beat



take away

remove a part



texture

how thick or thin the
sound is



thick

many layers at once



thin

only one or two



ti-ti

two sounds in one beat



together

at the same moment



trickle

a small run of water



tune

the shape the song
makes



voice

the sound you make



wave

water rolling over



whisper

talking with no buzz

WORD BOOK

🎵 words to xylophone

**words**

what the song says

**write it down**

keeping it so it lasts

**xylophone**

wooden bars you hit

WORD BOOK

The same words, in a list

For a teacher, or for anybody who would rather read than look at pictures.

WORD BOOK · CONTINUED

add	put another part in Topic 5.2
applause	the sound of thank you Topic 5.6
apple	two claps: ti-ti Topic 3.2
audience	the people listening Topic 2.5
banana	three claps Topic 3.2
bar	one set of four beats Topic 4.2
beat	one tap of the pulse Topic 1.4
begin	the very first sound Topic 2.4
bread	one clap: ta Topic 3.2
bright	sounds like sunshine Topic 4.1
calm	quiet and unhurried Topic 4.3
celebration	a day made for music Topic 5.1
chant	words said in rhythm Topic 3.2
choose	pick on purpose Topic 5.1

WORD BOOK • CONTINUED

chorus	everybody singing at once Topic 1.6
compose	make up your own Topic 4.4
composer	somebody who makes up music Topic 2.5
concert	playing for an audience Topic 5.6
copy	do it exactly the same Topic 1.2
cue	the signal that it is your turn Topic 5.4
dawn	the very start of the day Topic 1.6
day	the light half Topic 4.1
dress rehearsal	the real thing, with no audience Topic 5.5
drip	one drop landing Topic 2.1
dynamics	how loud or soft Topic 4.5
end	the sound that says it is finished Topic 2.4
expression	putting feeling into it Topic 4.3
fast	hurrying Topic 1.2

WORD BOOK · CONTINUED

favourite	the one you like best Topic 5.1
feedback	what a listener tells you Topic 2.6
feeling	what the music does to you Topic 4.1
four beats	one full bar Topic 4.4
getting louder	growing towards f Topic 4.5
getting softer	fading towards p Topic 4.5
hand sign	showing a note with your hand Topic 1.3
harmony	two notes at the same moment Topic 5.2
high	a fast wobble Topic 1.1
improve	make it better than last time Topic 2.6
improvise	make it up as you go Topic 1.5
instrument	a thing made for making sound Topic 1.4
job	the thing you are responsible for Topic 5.4
layer	sounds happening at the same time Topic 1.5

WORD BOOK · CONTINUED

listen	the first job of all Topic 1.6
loud	a big sound Topic 1.2
low	a slow wobble Topic 1.1
mi	the lower of the two notes Topic 1.3
moon	the light in the dark Topic 4.6
move	travel with the music Topic 4.3
night	the dark half Topic 4.1

WORD BOOK

orchestra	a big group of players together Topic 2.5
order	what comes first, next and last Topic 2.4
ostinato	a pattern that repeats Topic 3.3
part	your own bit of the music Topic 3.3
pentatonic	five notes, with two taken away Topic 3.4
percussion	things you hit, shake or scrape Topic 5.2
perform	play it for other people Topic 1.5
porridge	two claps: ti-ti Topic 3.6
portfolio	the folder where you keep your work Topic 1.6
pour	water tipped out Topic 2.1
proud	pleased with what you did Topic 5.6
pulse	the steady beat underneath Topic 1.4
record	keep the sound of it Topic 5.5
rehearse	practise the whole thing Topic 5.4

WORD BOOK · CONTINUED

repeat	do the same thing again Topic 3.3
rest	a silence you still count Topic 3.1
revise	go back and improve it Topic 5.1
rhythm	the pattern of long and short Topic 3.6
ripple	rings spreading on water Topic 2.2
river	water travelling Topic 2.5
running order	what happens, in order Topic 5.4
sequence	sounds in an order Topic 2.4
sh	a beat with no sound Topic 3.1
shadow y	sounds like a dark corner Topic 4.1
slow	taking your time Topic 1.2
so	the higher of the two notes Topic 1.3
soft	a small sound Topic 1.2
soundsc ape	a place made of sound Topic 2.3

WORD BOOK • CONTINUED

splash	water hit hard Topic 2.1
stave	the lines music is written on Topic 1.3
steady	always the same speed Topic 1.4
stick notation	rhythm written as marks Topic 4.2
still	not moving at all Topic 4.3
sunrise	when the light comes back Topic 4.6
syllable	one clap inside a word Topic 3.2
ta	one sound in one beat Topic 3.1
take away	remove a part Topic 5.2
texture	how thick or thin the sound is Topic 2.3
thick	many layers at once Topic 2.3
thin	only one or two Topic 2.3
ti-ti	two sounds in one beat Topic 3.1
together	at the same moment Topic 1.5

WORD BOOK • CONTINUED

trickle

a small run of water

Topic 2.1

tune

the shape the song makes

Topic 5.3

voice

the sound you make

Topic 1.1

wave

water rolling over

Topic 2.2

whisper

talking with no buzz

Topic 1.1

words

what the song says

Topic 5.3

**write it
down**

keeping it so it lasts

Topic 4.2

**xylopho
ne**

wooden bars you hit

Topic 3.4



The instruments, laid out for putting away.

WHERE IT ALL CAME FROM

Every true thing, and who told us

Every "Otto's true thing" in this book was checked against a named source before it was printed. Those sources are listed here so that anybody can go and check them.

Where a popular claim could not be traced, it was either left out or narrowed to the part that is actually documented, and what we deliberately did not say is printed underneath. A book that never had to do this has not checked anything.

Unit 1: The Dawn Chorus

- **The Dawn Chorus:** You sing with your throat, but a bird does not. A bird has a special sound box called a syrinx, deep in its chest where its windpipe splits in two. That is why some birds can sing two notes at the same time. [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Syrinx_\(bird_anatomy\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Syrinx_(bird_anatomy))
- **The Dawn Chorus:** Very early in the morning, birds all start singing at once. It is called the dawn chorus, and different kinds of bird join in at different times, so the chorus changes while it goes on. [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dawn_chorus_\(birds\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dawn_chorus_(birds))
- **The Dawn Chorus:** Birds sing most at the very start of the day, when the air is still and the world is quiet. A song travels better through calm quiet air than through a busy noisy morning. [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dawn_chorus_\(birds\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dawn_chorus_(birds)) **What we did not say:** The widely repeated claim that dawn song carries twenty times further than midday song has no primary measurement behind it, so no number is printed here.
- **The Dawn Chorus:** A singing bird is usually doing one of two jobs: telling other birds that this hedge is taken, or looking for a mate. It is a message, not just a nice noise. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Bird_vocalization
- **The Dawn Chorus:** Robins will sing in the middle of the night if there is a street light near their tree. They are not confused: light is one of the things that tells a robin it is time to sing. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/European_robin

WHERE IT ALL CAME FROM • CONTINUED

- **The Dawn Chorus:** The cuckoo sings only two notes, over and over, and always the same two. The higher one and the lower one are exactly the two notes you are learning to sing in this unit.
https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Common_cuckoo
- **The Dawn Chorus:** A barn owl's two ears are not level with each other. One is a little higher than the other, and that tiny difference is how the owl works out exactly where a sound is coming from in the dark. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Barn_owl
- **The Dawn Chorus:** Some birds copy sounds they were never born knowing. A starling can copy a telephone, a car alarm or another bird, and put all of them into one song.
https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Common_starling
- **The Dawn Chorus:** A cricket does not have a voice at all. It rubs one wing against the other, like drawing a stick along a comb, and that is the chirping you hear on a summer evening.
[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cricket_\(insect\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cricket_(insect))

WHERE IT ALL CAME FROM

Unit 2: The Stream

- **The Stream:** Sound travels more than four times faster through water than through air. If you put your ear against the side of a full bath and tap it, the sound arrives sooner than you expect.
https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Speed_of_sound
- **The Stream:** Whales sing to each other under the sea. Sound carries a very long way through water, much further than it does through air, so a whale can call to another whale it cannot see at all. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Whale_vocalization **What we did not say:** No distance figure is given. The often-quoted thousands of miles depends on conditions and is not a number a child can use.
- **The Stream:** Rain does not make one sound. Rain on a leaf, rain on a window, rain on a puddle and rain on a roof are four different sounds, all made by the same water.
<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Rain>
- **The Stream:** A composer called Smetana wrote a piece of music about a real river, the Vltava. It begins with two tiny streams played by two flutes, and they join together into one big tune, just as two streams join into a river. [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Vltava_\(Smetana\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Vltava_(Smetana))
- **The Stream:** Chopin never called his famous piece Raindrop. Somebody else gave it that name later, because one note keeps repeating all the way through it, like a drip that will not stop.
[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Prelude,_Op._28,_No._15_\(Chopin\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Prelude,_Op._28,_No._15_(Chopin))
- **The Stream:** In Saint-Saens's Aquarium, the shimmering water sound is made by a glass harmonica, an instrument played by rubbing wet fingers on glass.
https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Carnival_of_the_Animals
- **The Stream:** If you fill bottles with different amounts of water and tap them, each one sings a different note. The more water there is, the lower the note goes.
https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Glass_harp
- **The Stream:** Frogs call together in a chorus, and they take turns. If they all called at exactly the same moment, no frog could be heard on its own. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Frog>
- **The Stream:** Dolphins make clicking sounds and then listen for the echo coming back. The echo tells them what is in front of them, even in water too murky to see through.
https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Animal_echolocation

WHERE IT ALL CAME FROM

Unit 3: The Long Table

- **The Long Table:** You have been keeping a steady beat since before you were born. Your heart does it all day and all night without being asked, and it does not speed up just because the music does. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Heart_rate
- **The Long Table:** Every word is already made of beats. We call them syllables, and you can hear them by clapping a word: ap-ple has two claps and ba-na-na has three. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Syllable>
- **The Long Table:** A pentatonic scale has five notes instead of seven. Two notes have been taken away on purpose, and that is what makes it so hard to play anything that sounds wrong. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pentatonic_scale
- **The Long Table:** A pattern that repeats and repeats underneath a piece of music has a proper name: an ostinato. The word comes from an old Italian word meaning stubborn, which is exactly what it is. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ostinato>
- **The Long Table:** The words ta and ti-ti are not made up. They come from a way of teaching music that a Hungarian composer called Zoltan Kodaly helped to spread, and children all over the world chant them. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kod%C3%A1ly_method
- **The Long Table:** The crunch you hear when you eat a crisp is much louder inside your own head than it is to anybody else. The sound travels straight through the bones of your skull to your ears. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Bone_conduction
- **The Long Table:** Pulse and rhythm are not the same thing. The pulse is the steady counting underneath, and the rhythm is the pattern of long and short sounds you put on top of it. [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pulse_\(music\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pulse_(music))
- **The Long Table:** The word xylophone means wood sound. A xylophone has wooden bars, and the longer the bar, the lower the note it makes. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Xylophone>
- **The Long Table:** People have always sung while doing hard jobs together, like hauling ropes or grinding corn. The song keeps everybody pulling at the same moment, which makes the work easier. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Work_song

WHERE IT ALL CAME FROM

Unit 4: The Turning Day

- **The Turning Day:** Music built on a minor scale usually strikes listeners as darker or sadder than music built on a major one. Almost everybody agrees about the feeling, even though it is only a small change in the notes. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Minor_scale**What we did not say:** No explanation is offered for WHY. Every explanation that could be traced was either cultural or contested.
- **The Turning Day:** There is a whole kind of music named after the night. It is called a nocturne, and it is usually quiet, slow and thoughtful, the way the world is when it is dark. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Nocturne>
- **The Turning Day:** An owl's feathers have soft fringed edges, so an owl can fly almost silently. It is not being polite: it needs to hear the mouse, and its own wings would drown the mouse out. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Owl>
- **The Turning Day:** Bats hunt in the dark by shouting and listening. Most of the shouts are too high for you to hear at all, which is why a bat seems silent when it is actually being very loud. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Animal_echolocation
- **The Turning Day:** The letters p and f in music are short for Italian words: piano meaning soft and forte meaning strong. Musicians have been writing them for hundreds of years. [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dynamics_\(music\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dynamics_(music))
- **The Turning Day:** The piano is named after being quiet. Its full old name meant soft and loud, because unlike the instruments before it, you could play it both ways just by changing your fingers. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Piano>
- **The Turning Day:** Moths come out at night and are drawn to a light, while butterflies fly in the day. They are close relatives who chose opposite halves of the day. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Moth>
- **The Turning Day:** The words of Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star were written as a poem by Jane Taylor in 1806. The tune is an older French one, and the two were put together afterwards. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Twinkle,_Twinkle,_Little_Star**What we did not say:** Mozart did not write this tune. He wrote variations on the French melody, which is a different thing, so his name is left out.
- **The Turning Day:** The nightingale is named for singing after dark. Most birds stop when the light goes, but this one carries on into the night. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Common_nightingale

WHERE IT ALL CAME FROM

Unit 5: The Big Rock

- **The Big Rock:** In Britain, church bells are rung in careful patterns rather than tunes. It is called change ringing, each bell is pulled by a different person, and everybody has to count. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Change_ringing
- **The Big Rock:** Clapping to say thank you is very old indeed. Audiences in ancient Rome clapped, and so did audiences long before that. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Applause>
- **The Big Rock:** A conductor makes no sound at all. Their whole job is to keep everybody together and to show how loud, how fast and how gentle the music should be, using only their hands. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Conducting>
- **The Big Rock:** A big orchestra can have around a hundred players in it, all playing at the same moment and all watching one person. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Orchestra>
- **The Big Rock:** Beethoven wrote his most famous celebration music when he was almost completely deaf. He could not hear the choir that sang it. [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Symphony_No._9_\(Beethoven\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Symphony_No._9_(Beethoven))
- **The Big Rock:** In Indonesia, a whole village orchestra of tuned metal instruments is called a gamelan. Nobody owns their own instrument: the set belongs to everybody together. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gamelan>
- **The Big Rock:** Japanese taiko drums can be taller than the person playing them, and the players move their whole bodies. Watching them is as much a part of it as listening. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Taiko>
- **The Big Rock:** Saint-Saens would not let his *Carnival of the Animals* be published while he was alive, in case people thought he was not a serious composer. It is now the piece he is most famous for. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Carnival_of_the_Animals
- **The Big Rock:** When a group of people sing together, their breathing falls into step with the music and with each other. Singing in a choir is something your whole body joins in with. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Choir>
- **The Big Rock:** Harmony is what happens when two different notes sound at the same moment. One person cannot make harmony alone, which is why it belongs at the end of this book. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Harmony>

THE SQUARE CODES

Every code in this book

All 31 of them, with the topic they belong to and the full address written out, so a teacher can reach any of them by typing instead of scanning.

Every address was requested and confirmed working before this book went to print, on 2026-08-03. They all lead to free public archives: Wikimedia Commons, Wikipedia, xeno-canto and IMSLP. There is no advertising, no account and nothing that expires.

- | | |
|------------|--|
| 1.1 | HEAR European robin song, xeno-canto XC812816
https://xeno-canto.org/812816 |
| 1.2 | HEAR Common blackbird song on Wikimedia Commons
https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Common_Blackbird_song_(Turdus_merula).ogg |
| 1.3 | HEAR Common cuckoo, xeno-canto XC457076 on Wikimedia Commons
https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Cuculus_canorus_-_Common_Cuckoo_XC457076.mp3 |
| 1.4 | HEAR Tawny owl on Wikimedia Commons
https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Tawny_Owl_(Strix_aluco).ogg |
| 1.5 | READ Dawn chorus, Wikipedia
https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dawn_chorus_(birds) |
| 1.6 | LISTEN Saint-Saens, The Carnival of the Animals: Voliere, on Wikimedia Commons
https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Saint-Saens_-_The_Carnival_of_the_Animals_-_10_Voli%C3%A8re.ogg |
| 2.1 | HEAR The sound of rain, Wikimedia Commons
https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Sound_of_rain.ogg |
| 2.2 | HEAR Water flowing, pouring and trickling, Wikimedia Commons
https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Water_flowng_pouring_trickling.ogg |
| 2.3 | HEAR Frogs croaking in a chorus at night, Wikimedia Commons
https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Frogs_croak_calling_chorus_at_night.ogg |
| 2.5 | LISTEN Chopin, Prelude Op. 28 No. 15 (Raindrop), on Wikimedia Commons
https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Ivan_Ili%C4%87-Chopin_-_Prelude_no._15_in_D_flat_major.ogg |

THE SQUARE CODES · CONTINUED

2.5	LISTEN Smetana, Ma vlast: Vltava (The Moldau), on Wikimedia Commons https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Smetana,_M%C3%A1_vlast_-_Vltava_-_The_Moldau.ogg
2.5	LISTEN Saint-Saens, The Carnival of the Animals: Aquarium, on Wikimedia Commons https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Saint-Saens_-_The_Carnival_of_the_Animals_-_07_Aquarium.ogg
2.6	SEE Vltava, the printed score at IMSLP https://imslp.org/wiki/Vltava,_JB_1:112/2_(Smetana,_Bed%C5%99ich)
3.1	READ Pulse in music, Wikipedia https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pulse_(music)
3.4	READ Pentatonic scale, Wikipedia https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pentatonic_scale
3.2	READ Rhythm, Wikipedia https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Rhythm
3.3	READ Ostinato, Wikipedia https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ostinato
3.5	LISTEN Saint-Saens, The Carnival of the Animals, complete, on Wikimedia Commons https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Camille_Saint-Sa%C3%ABns_-_The_Carnival_of_the_Animals.ogg
3.6	LISTEN Saint-Saens, The Carnival of the Animals: Tortues, on Wikimedia Commons https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Saint-Saens_-_The_Carnival_of_the_Animals_-_04_Tortues.ogg
4.1	LISTEN Saint-Saens, The Carnival of the Animals: Fossiles, on Wikimedia Commons https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Saint-Saens_-_The_Carnival_of_the_Animals_-_12_Fossiles.ogg

THE SQUARE CODES • CONTINUED

4.5	READ Dynamics in music, Wikipedia https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dynamics_(music)
4.3	LISTEN Chopin, Prelude Op. 28 No. 15, performed by Giorgi Latsabidze, on Commons https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Chopin_Prelude_Op_28_N_15_Giorgi_Latsabidze_performs.ogg
4.2	READ Musical notation, Wikipedia https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Musical_notation
4.4	SEE Chopin's Preludes, Op. 28: the printed score at IMSLP https://imslp.org/wiki/Preludes,_Op.28_(Chopin,_Fr%C3%A9d%C3%A9ric)
4.6	READ Tempo, Wikipedia https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tempo
5.1	LISTEN Beethoven, Symphony No. 9, finale, on Wikimedia Commons https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:PMLP01607-Symphony_No.9,_Op.125_(Beethoven,_Ludwig_van),_IV_Presto.ogg
5.2	READ Harmony, Wikipedia https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Harmony
5.3	HEAR Cathedral bells at Fribourg ringing, on Wikimedia Commons https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Cathedral_Fribourg_bells_ringing_01.ogg
5.5	HEAR Applause on Wikimedia Commons https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Applause.ogg
5.4	READ Conducting, Wikipedia https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Conducting
5.6	LISTEN Saint-Saens, The Carnival of the Animals: Final, on Wikimedia Commons https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Saint-Saens_-_The_Carnival_of_the_Animals_-_14_Final.ogg

FOR TEACHERS

The scheme of work, mapped

Every row of the Year 2 music scheme of work, in the sheet's own order and its own words, beside the title this book gives it. Nothing has been added to the scheme and nothing left out: five chapters, thirty topics.

Unit 1	The Dawn Chorus Unit 1 Animal voices
1.1	Wake the whole hedgerow up Vocal warm ups & exploring voice qualities (high/low, fast/slow, whisper, etc.)
1.2	Be the animal, sound and all Animal sound exploration with movement and imitation
1.3	So and mi, and two little lines Introduce so / mi (hand signs) and two-line stave
1.4	One animal, one steady beat Representing animals with classroom instruments to a steady pulse
1.5	Make up an animal piece Small-group improvisation/composition and short class performance
1.6	Looking back at the Dawn Chorus Reflection / assessment / portfolio evidence
Unit 2	The Stream Unit 2 Water, water, everywhere
2.1	All the sounds water makes Explore water sounds and vocabulary (voice, body, objects)
2.2	So and mi songs, with actions Sing so/mi songs with actions (practise and consolidate)
2.3	Build a rainstorm out of layers Create soundscapes / texture building (parachute/props, layering)
2.4	Put the water in order Sequence and layer sounds (simple use of sequencing / organising sounds)

FOR TEACHERS • CONTINUED

2.5**Three composers went to the water**

Listening examples (Raindrop, Vltava, Aquarium) and discussion

2.6**Show us the stream**

Performance / reflection / teacher feedback

Unit 3**The Long Table**

Unit 3 Musical food

3.1**Ta, ti-ti, and the sound of nothing**

Introduce ta, ti-ti and sh (rest); pulse awareness activities

3.2**Every food word has a rhythm**

Match rhythms to food-word syllables and chant practise

FOR TEACHERS

3.3	A pattern that will not stop Compose simple rhythmic ostinatos and combine groups
3.4	Five notes, one long table Use pitched and unpitched instruments to perform parts (pentatonic CDEGA)
3.5	Play it, hear it, mend it Group performance, peer feedback and refinement
3.6	Looking back at the Long Table Short assessment / reflection / portfolio update
Unit 4	The Turning Day Unit 4 Light and dark
4.1	Bright music and shadowy music Listen and respond to light vs dark music; describe feelings
4.2	Writing rhythm down with sticks Continue ta / ti-ti / sh notation and stick notation practise
4.3	Move the way the music moves Movement responses and expressive choices to recorded music
4.4	Four beats, and what you put in them Compose small ta/ti-ti/sh patterns (groups) and organise into 4-beat structures
4.5	Loud, soft, and everything between Performances, class discussion on expression and dynamics
4.6	Looking back at the Turning Day Reflection / assessment
Unit 5	The Big Rock Unit 5 Celebration

FOR TEACHERS • CONTINUED

5.1**Choose the best of the year**

Select and revise favourite pieces from the year

5.2**Add a part, and then take one away**

Refine songs (add pulse, simple percussion parts, harmonies)

5.3**Write our own celebration song**

Compose and learn short celebratory songs as a class

5.4**Who does what, and when**

Rehearse performance logistics and run-throughs (groups)

5.5**The dress rehearsal**

Dress rehearsal / recording / final tweaks

5.6**The Big Rock concert**

Final performance, reflection and portfolio completion

**FOR TEACHERS**

The pupil-facing titles are this book's own invention and sit on top of the scheme; they never replace it. Both are printed in the contents and again here, so any page can be matched to your own plan at a glance.

Notation follows the scheme exactly. Units 1 and 2 are pre-notation and work in so and mi, hand signs and the two-line stave. Stick notation arrives in Topic 3.1, where the scheme introduces ta, ti-ti and sh, and is consolidated in Unit 4. The pentatonic set in Topic 3.4 is CDEGA as named, with F and B removed.

Every rhythm, ostinato, layered part and melody printed in this book was checked by software before it was typeset: bars must fill their time signature, layered parts must share a bar length, a two-line stave may carry only so and mi, and a pentatonic part may not contain F or B. A pattern that does not add up cannot appear on these pages.

PRIME BOOKS

Well done

Music & Acting, Year 2

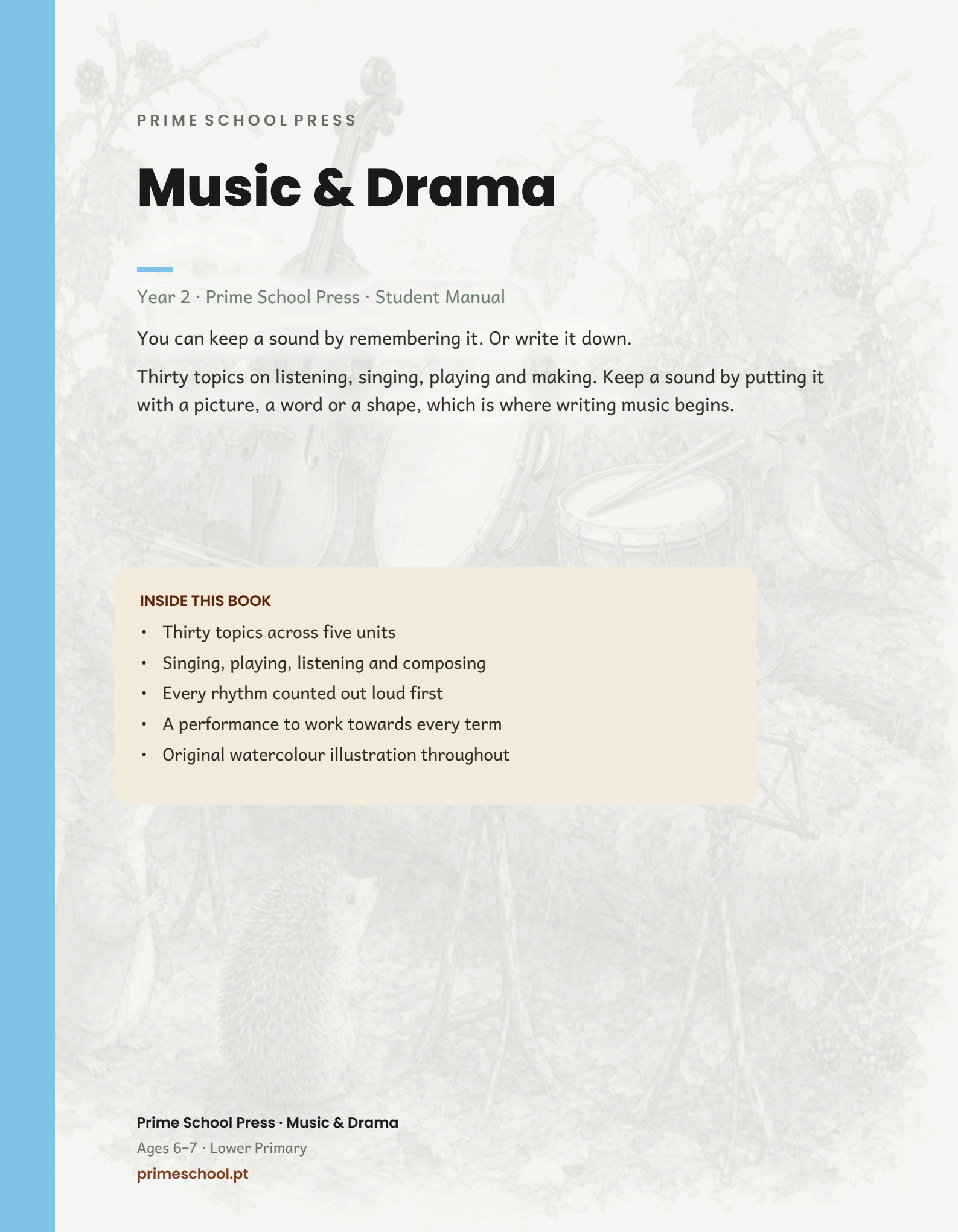
This is to say that

has finished a whole year of making sounds on purpose, keeping them, and giving them away.

They can sing so and mi, read a rhythm, keep their own part going while three others play, and stand up in front of people and perform.

Signed

PRIME SCHOOL



PRIME SCHOOL PRESS

Music & Drama

Year 2 · Prime School Press · Student Manual

You can keep a sound by remembering it. Or write it down.

Thirty topics on listening, singing, playing and making. Keep a sound by putting it with a picture, a word or a shape, which is where writing music begins.

INSIDE THIS BOOK

- Thirty topics across five units
- Singing, playing, listening and composing
- Every rhythm counted out loud first
- A performance to work towards every term
- Original watercolour illustration throughout

Prime School Press · Music & Drama

Ages 6–7 · Lower Primary

primeschool.pt